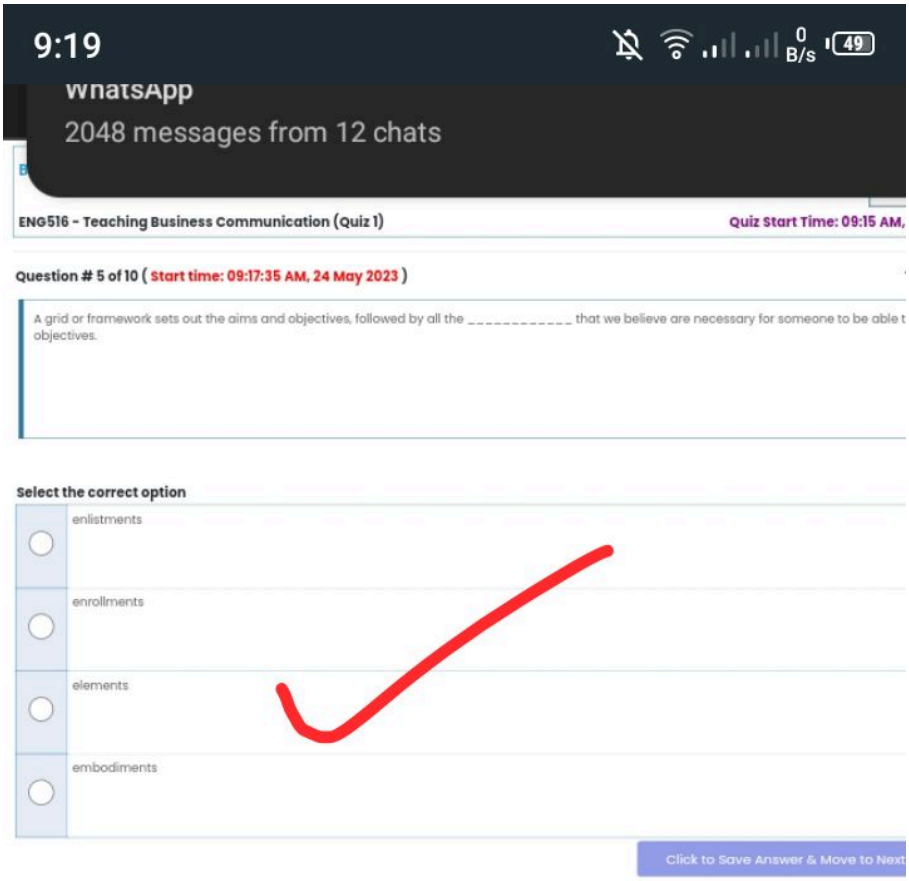
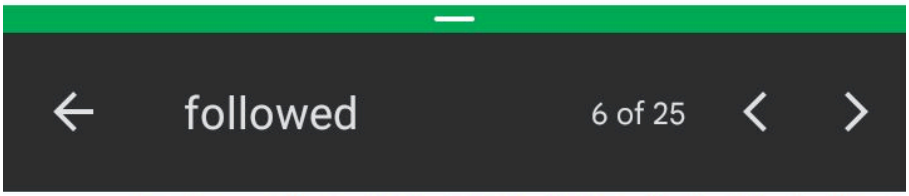




The syllabus provides an ordered structure for what is to be covered. It places the sele language into orderly, manageable chunks, with both the content and the order matched to the lear and their situation.

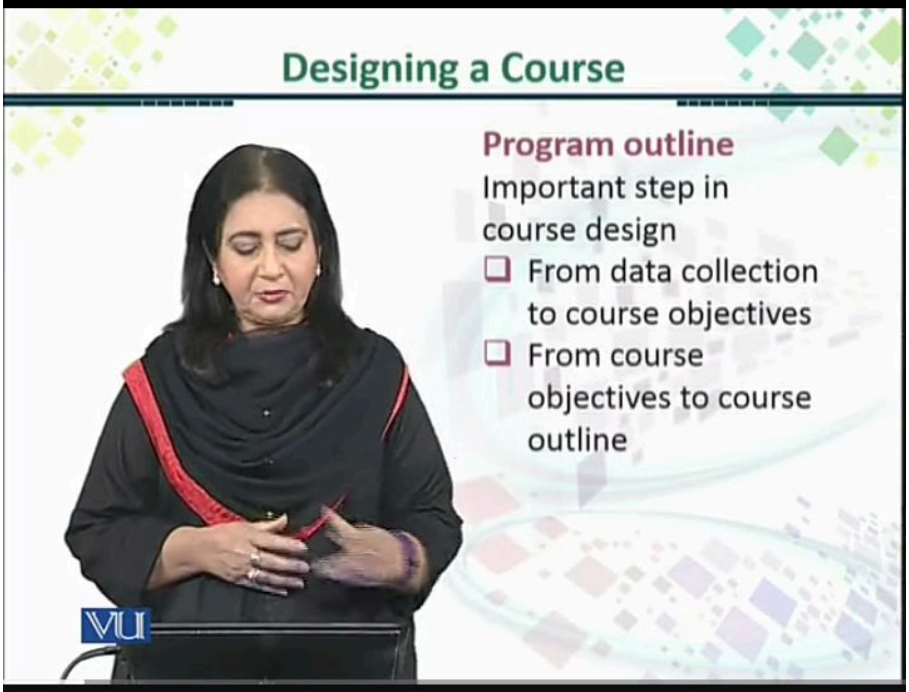
Topic- 046: Using a Grid

A useful technique is to use a grid or framework in making a syllabus. A grid or framework out the aims and objectives, followed by all the elements that we believe are necessary for someone t able to meet those objectives. The main components of this framework are based on the competen identified as: Linguistic competence (Language based), Discourse competence (identification of poss discourse learners will encounter, specialist knowledge) and Intercultural competence (communica needs in international business/educational environment).

The syllabus will take into account not only what is to be learnt but how it is to be learnt and ho will be assessed in terms of achieving course objectives, using the guidelines offered by communica language teaching and the insights gained through the needs analysis. Grids normally consist combination of the following components, sometimes called threads, because they weave through course and could be seen as holding it together:

- Grammar (e.g. tenses, word order, verb patterns, relative clauses)
- Lexis (e.g. vocabulary, idioms, expressions, collocations)
- Pronunciation (e.g. intonation, rhythm, stress, chunking)
- Functions (e.g. complaining, agreeing, persuading, explaining)
- Business skills (e.g. presenting, negotiating, telephoning, socializing)
- Topics (e.g. finance, marketing, production, management)
- Learning strategies (e.g. learning styles, recording vocabulary, preparing for a test)
- Situations (e.g. assisting visitors, checking into a hotel, running a meeting)
- Texts (e.g. examples of spoken or written discourse)

8:56



ENG516_Topic042

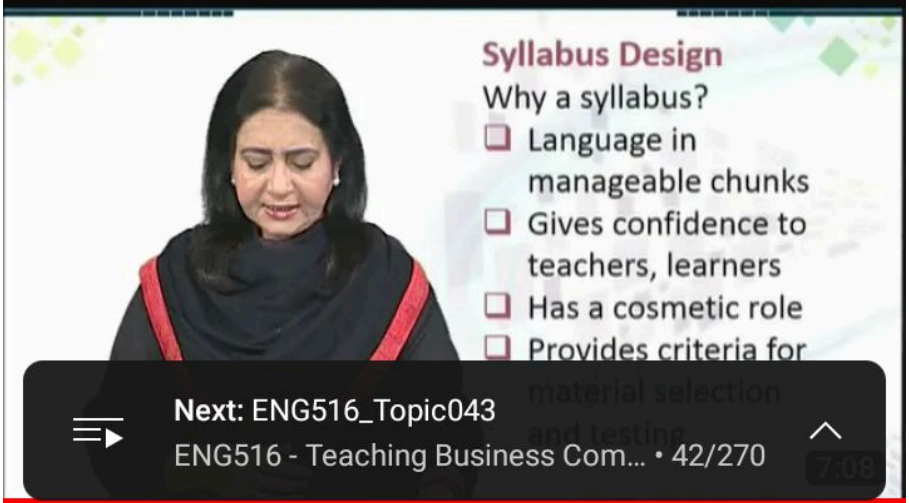
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Quiz

MC190400953: FARHANA SALEEM

ENG516 - Teaching Business Communication (Quiz 1) Quiz Start Tim

Question # 7 of 10 (Start time: 05:37:40 PM, 23 May 2023)

In business communication while designing a course, important step in course designing include:_____

Select the correct option

- data collection
- all the given options
- course outline
- course objectives



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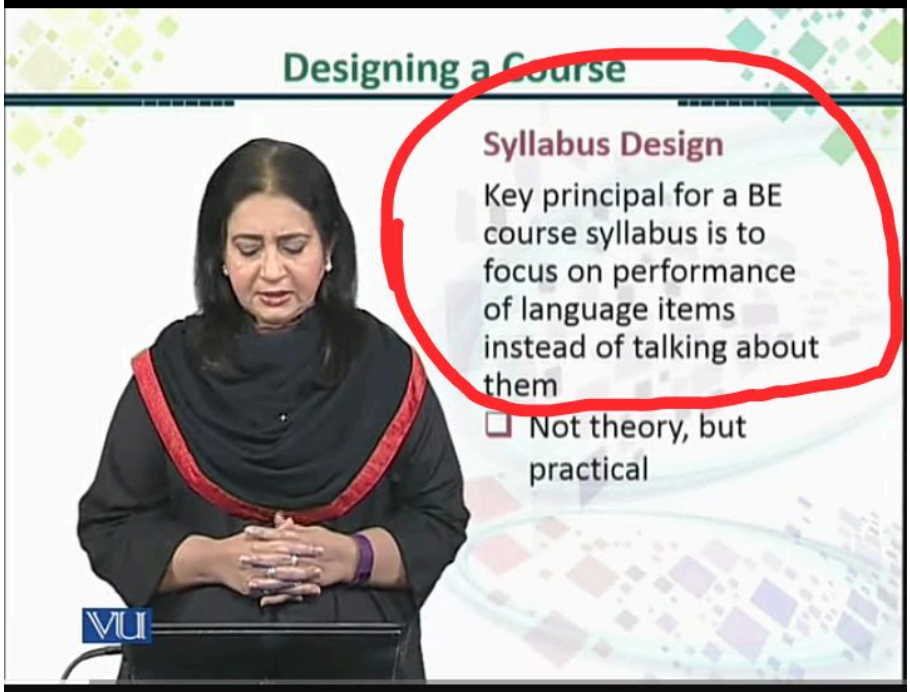
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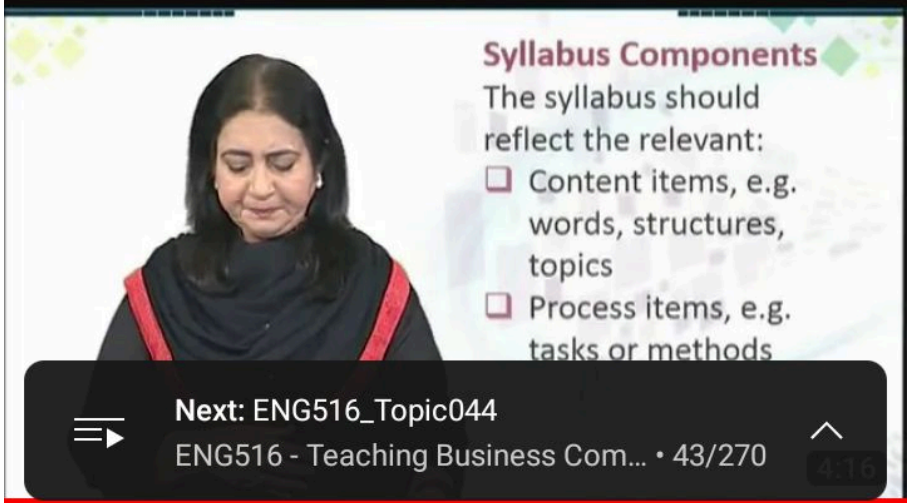
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Question # 9 of 10 (Start time: 09:13:58 PM, 23 May 2023)

2. Key principal for a Business English course is to focus on _____ of language items instead of talking about them.

Select the correct option

- pre-performance
- performance
- confirmance
- conformance

Click to Save Answer & Move to Next

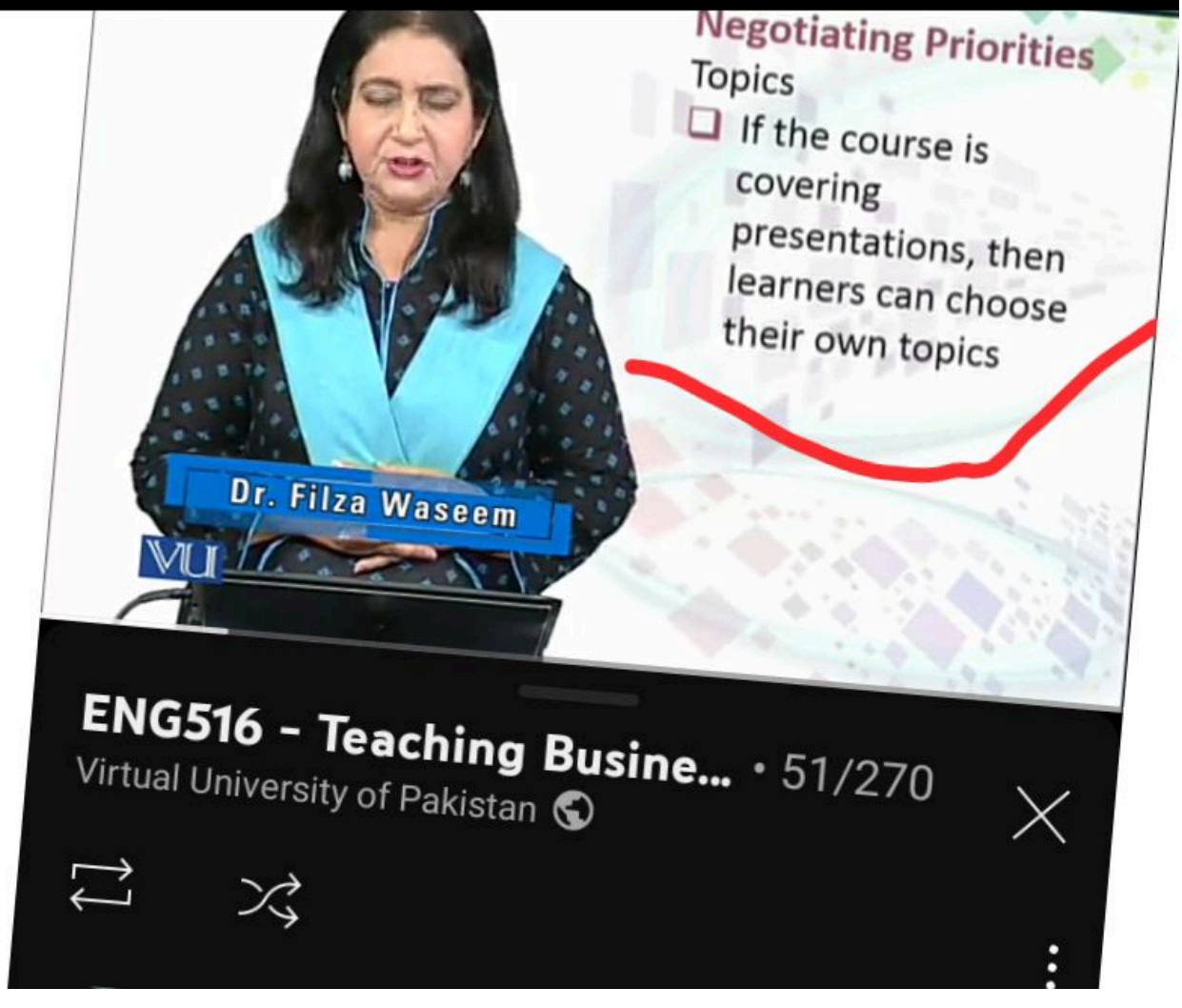
Question # 4 of 10 (Start time: 04:18:00 PM, 23 May 2023)

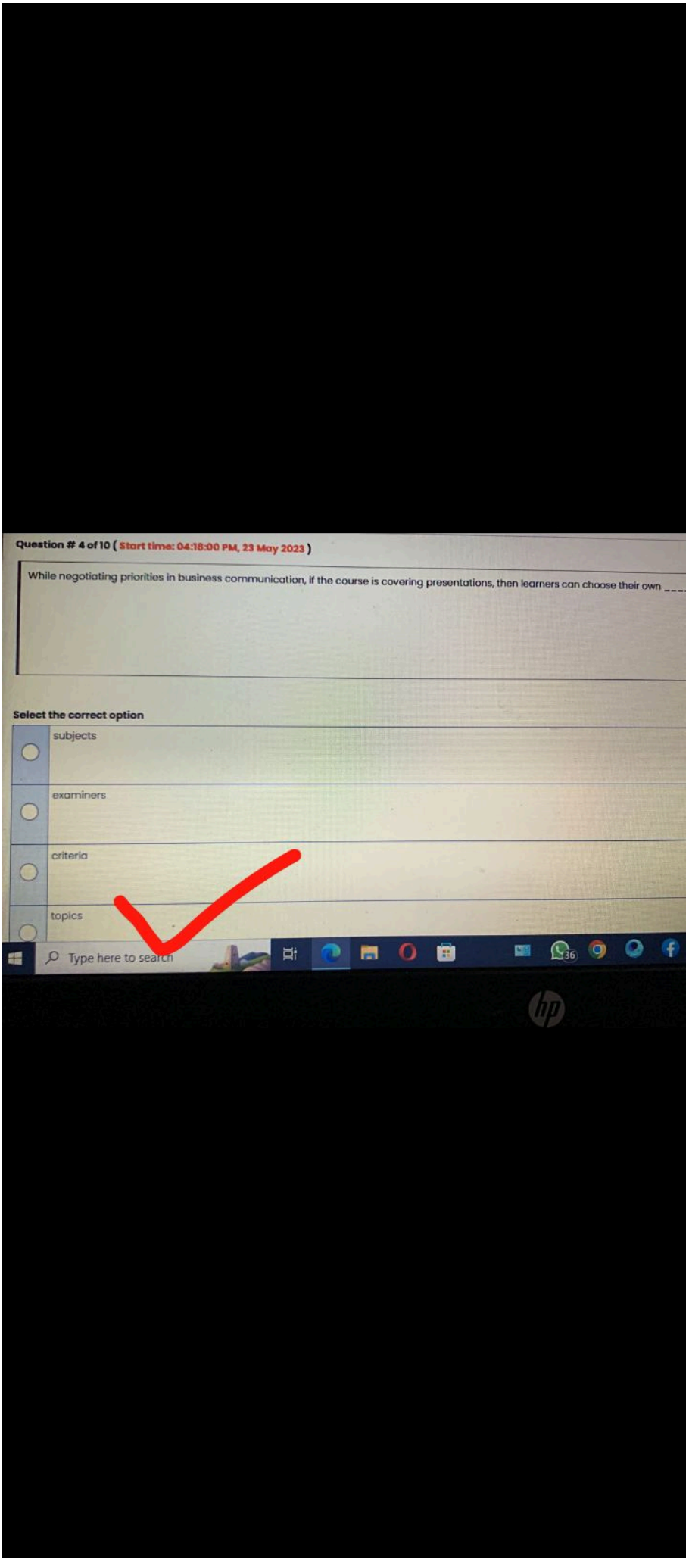
While negotiating priorities in business communication, if the course is covering presentations, then learners can choose their own ____

Select the correct option

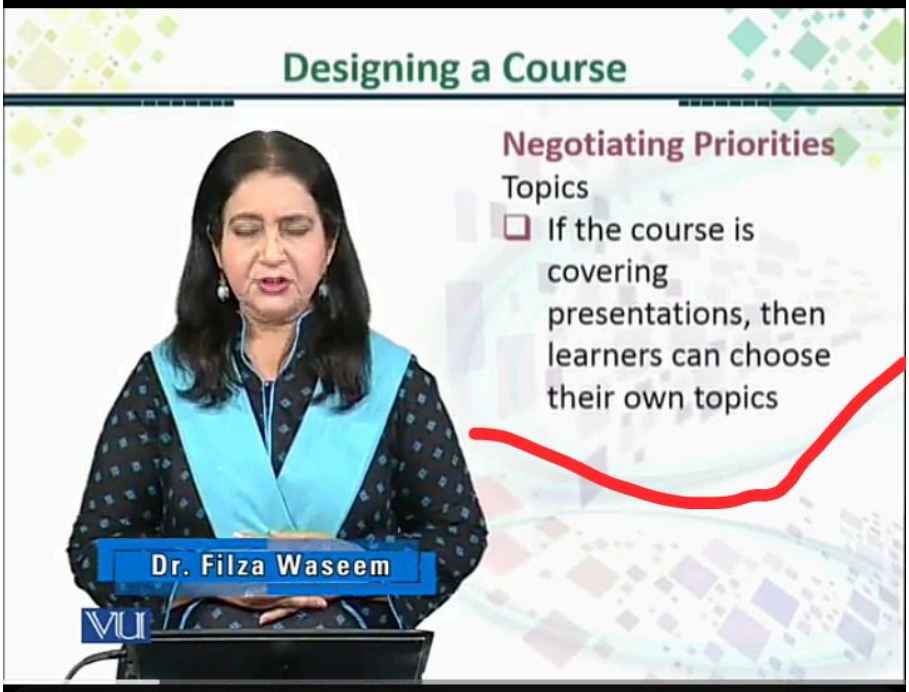
- subjects
- examiners
- criteria
- topics

Type here to search



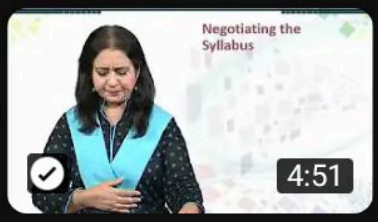

Question # 4 of 10 (Start time: 04:18:00 PM, 23 May 2023)
While negotiating priorities in business communication, if the course is covering presentations, then learners can choose their own ____
Select the correct option
subjects
examiners
criteria
topics
Type here to search

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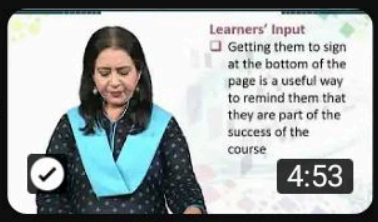


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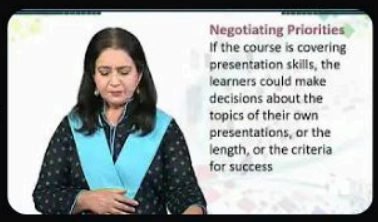
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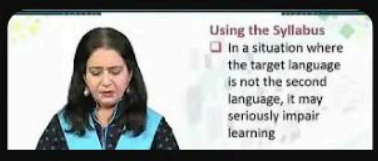
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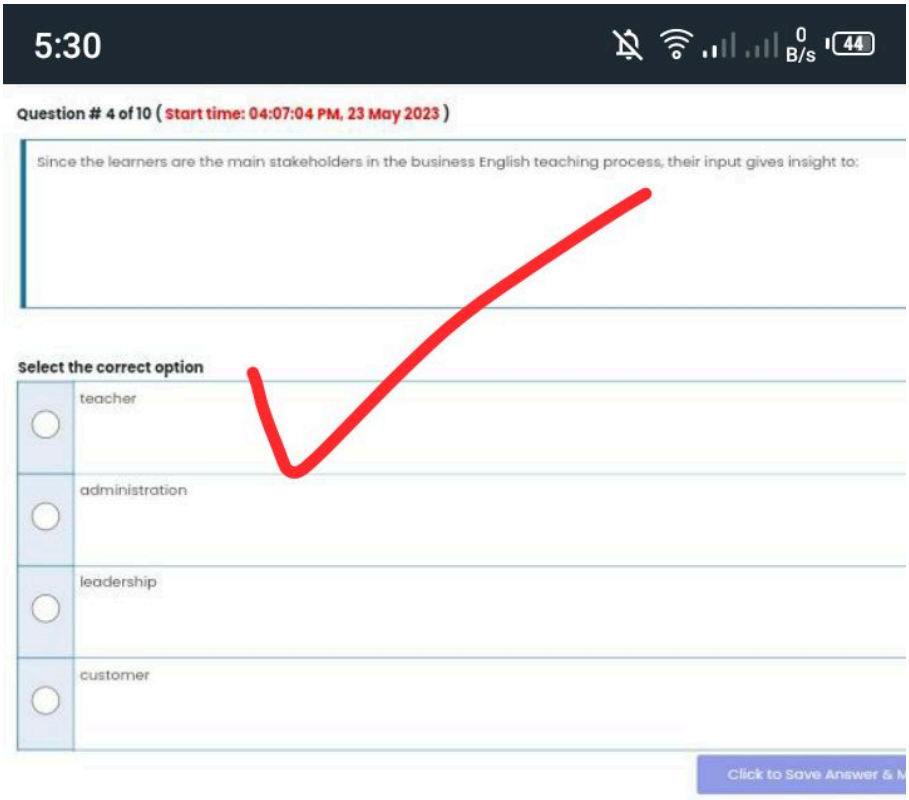
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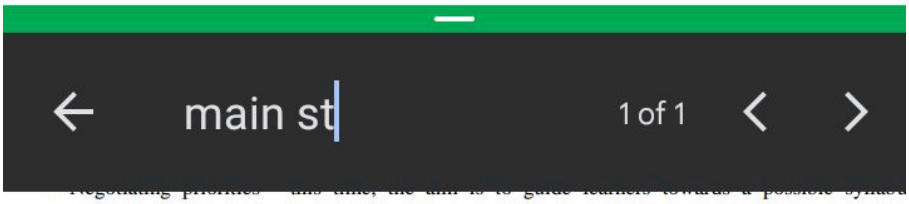


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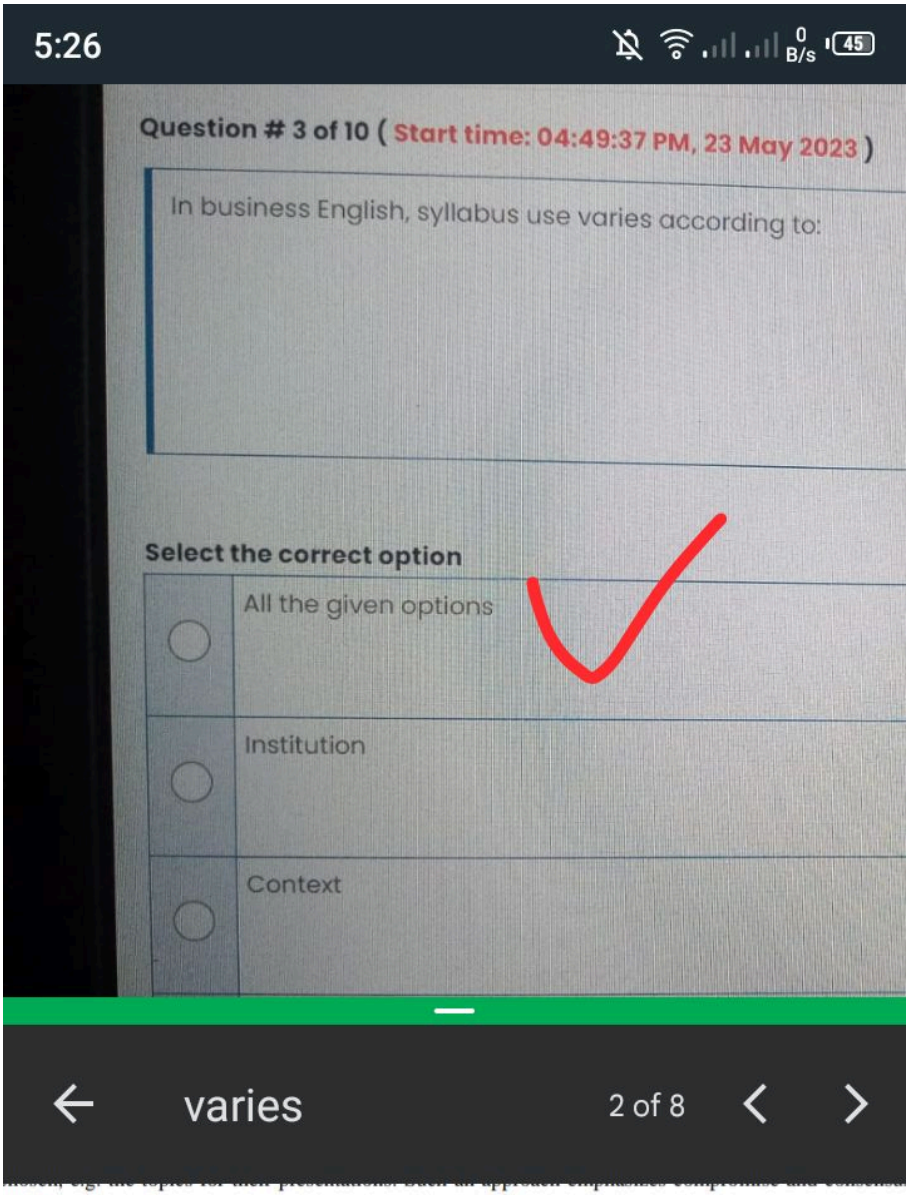
suggesting possible options. A variation on this is to give learners different options during the cours they want to do this or that next week? Teachers might allow learners to develop their own tasks activities. For example, if the course is covering presentation skills, the learners could make deci about the topics of their own presentations, or the length, or the criteria for success. Such an appr emphasizes the need for consensus and compromise, which are important elements in group work.

Topic- 050: Using Learner's Input

Since the learners are the main stakeholders in the process, their input is crucial. It gives in to the teacher about the pace of the course and course content. The teacher can give the cl questionnaire to fill questions about their own preferences, and then pass the sheets around so everyone can see what their colleagues want and do not want and can understand that different p have different needs. This information is then used as the basis for a third question, the answer to whi

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in effect, the syllabus as generated by the group. It will be an amalgam of the different priorities that surfaced. Generating the syllabus in this way brings home to the learners that what may happen is act a compromise. Getting them to sign at the bottom of the page is a useful way to remind them that the



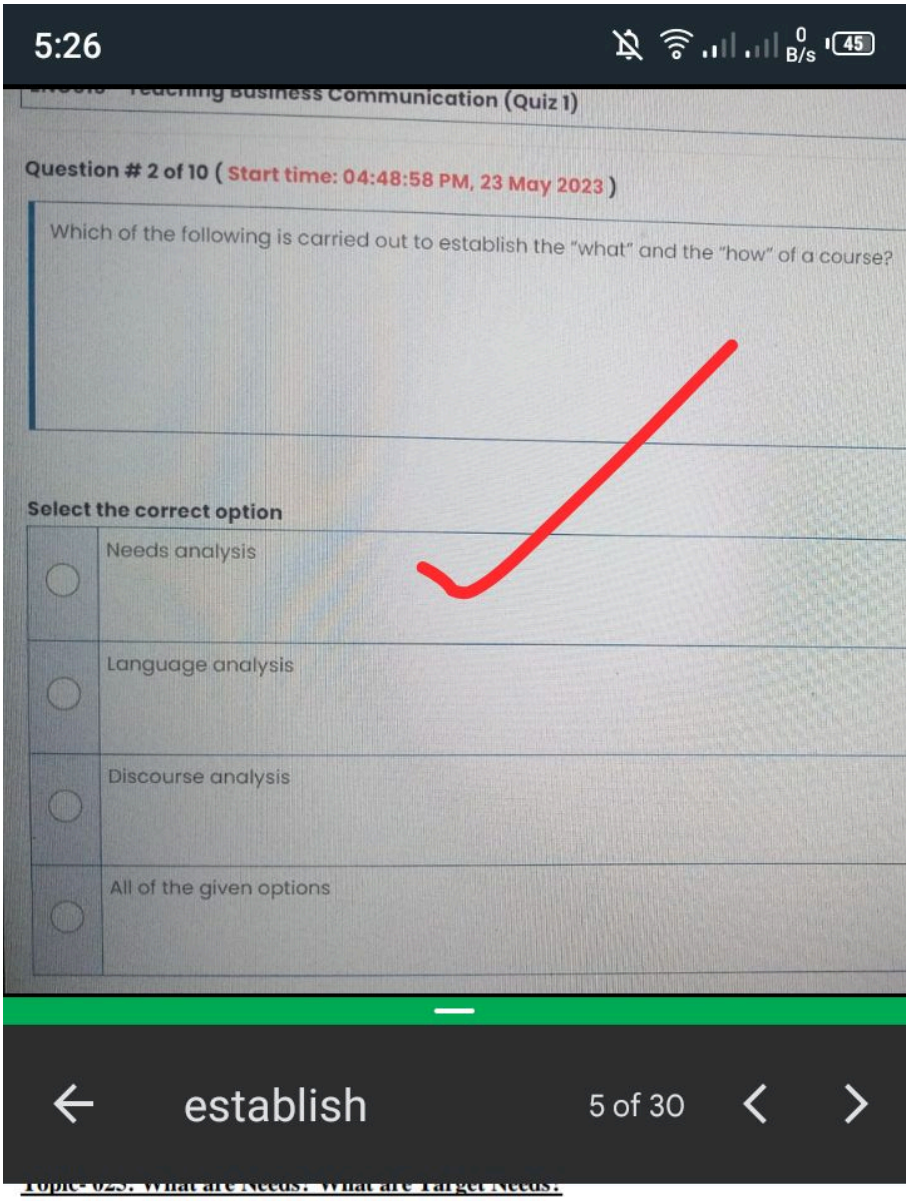
which are important in group work.

Another way to negotiate the syllabus is to work on the existing objectives and refine them to sui he needs of a particular class. Content items can be changed, added or removed. A sample objective: locument, based on pre-course discussions between employees of two companies, can be shared witl tudents. They can look at the list which is a mixture of communication skills and specific conten elevant only to the people concerned. The teacher can then raise questions to reconfirm this particula earner group's priorities, their needs of professional content and whether they want to add, remove o change any item.

Topic- 052: Using the Syllabus

The use of syllabus varies according to teaching context, country and institution. The humar actor and individual characteristics are also factors as are resources, human and material, and the eaching approach. Where there are ample materials and resources to draw up a detailed syllabus, teacher: nay find it useful to work mainly from it as the basis of their teaching, using specific materials. Ir affluent settings, teachers may be allowed to complete freedom in designing their course program; in such cases the syllabus may be ignored or be non-existent. And teachers would have the freedom to draw thei own new, independent program, based on their preferences and needs. With an experienced, competen and creative teacher and mature learners, such a program could be an exciting unique teaching/learning experience.

However, the disadvantages in most contexts outweigh the advantages. It means a prohibitive amount of work for the teacher. There might be some gaps in content. In a situation where the targe anguage is not the second language (spoken outside the classroom) it may seriously impair learning There is a lack of clear structure. Teachers and students both do not get a sense of progress, and evaluation of learning outcomes is difficult. Where only one book can be afforded by the students, it can



Topic-025: What are Needs? What are Target Needs?

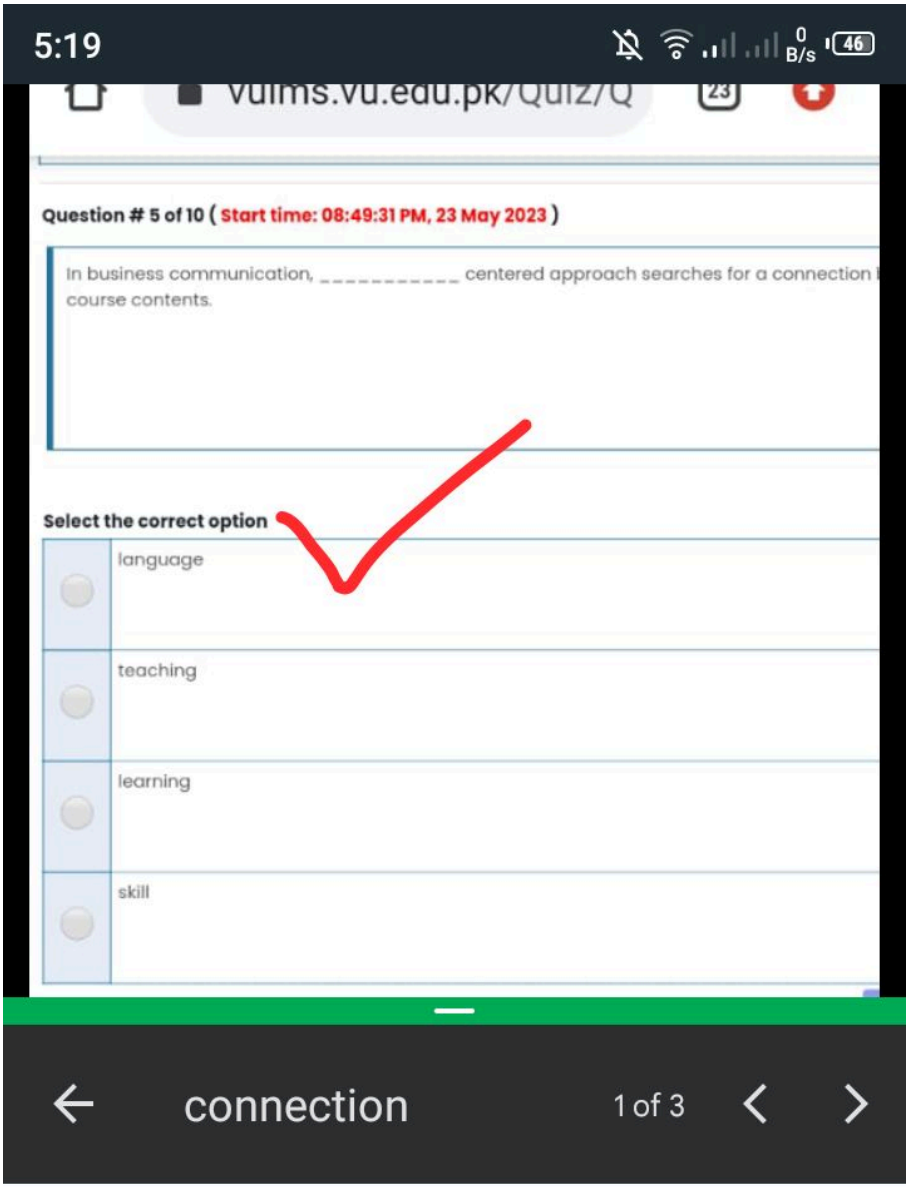
The difference between Business English (BE) and General English (GE) courses is ba Business English aims to fulfill the needs of business and management students. What are tl The basic aim of a needs analysis is to collect and examine critically, information about situation (where the students are at present) and the target situation (where they would like end of the teaching).

Needs analysis, carried out to establish the "what" and the "how" of a course, is the f Business Communication course development, followed by curriculum design, materials methodology, assessment, and evaluation. However, these stages should not be seen as sepa proceeding in a linear fashion. They come at the pre-course stage. The teacher needs to know t the learners so that the objectives of the course may be decided. Business English learners precisely defined needs than general English learners and these needs should be incorpor course objectives. It is useful to see the needs analysis stage as consisting of three separate elements:

- The range of communication and language required in the learner's present of future p
- The current ability of the learner in terms of language and communication.
- The actual objective of the training program .

In order to find this we need to address the following questions:

- What type of information do we need to get?
- How can we get this information?
- How can we translate this information into course objectives?



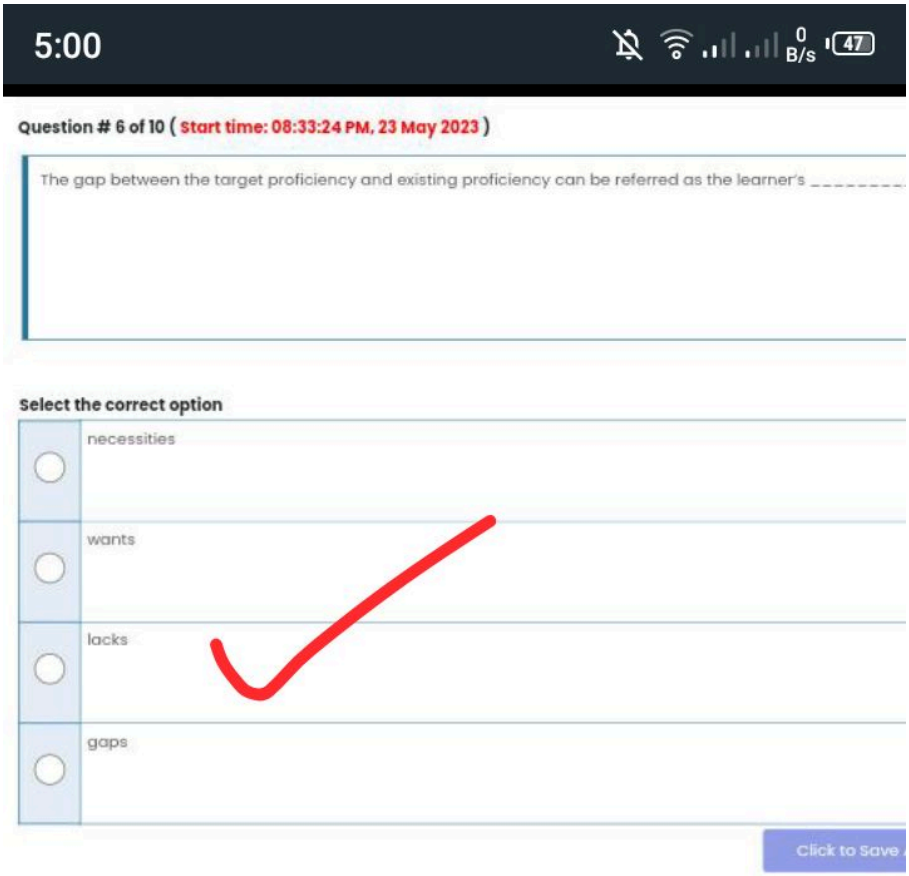
Topic- 037: Aims

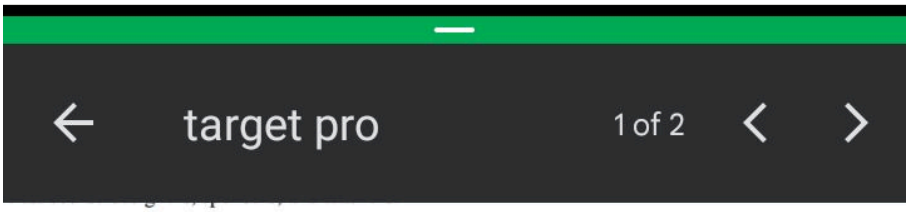
Designing a Business English course is a matter of making a series of decisions based on information gathered during a needs analysis about learners' communication, business and pedagogical needs. The next step is to interpret that data, design a course program and choose appropriate materials. A needs analysis has a direct influence on course design – the development of syllabus, materials, methodology and evaluation. A useful place to start is to decide on the course aims / what we (and others) want out of the course.

Course design is the process through which the raw data about a learning need is interpreted in order to produce a series of teaching learning experiences, aiming to lead the students to a particular state of knowledge. Care is needed as there is no one-to-one transfer from needs analysis to course design as there is conflict between learner needs and learner wants. There are external constraints (like classroom facilities/time) that will restrict what is happening.

Aims for a Business English course are general statements about why the course is happening. What are the overall aims which the course aims to achieve? A certain degree of specificity is required in designing a BE course, therefore pedagogically it comes under the umbrella of ESP. Related to this specificity is the choice of the content, the language to be used and taught, and the training style. Content, (which has to be related to the area) Language (discourse used in the area), communication (effective as per requirement of workplace) as well as the training style will depend on the initial needs analysis Aims of a course depend on a large degree to the approach which is taken for a course design. Various approaches have been used to design courses. The language centered course design (most familiar to teachers, simplest) draws a direct connection between needs analysis of the target situation and course contents. The learner is used as a means to identify the target situation. Instead of teaching the whole area as in a general English course, only the restricted area is taught and the learner has no further role to play. It seems logical as it aims to start with the learner's needs, proceeds through various stages of analysis to syllabus, to materials and then evaluation.

However, it covers only a restricted area of language to be taught to learners unlike in GE. Learners' needs are not catered at all. It seems learner–centered but actually after using the learner to identify the target area, it ignores the learner. It fails to recognize that learners are people and that learning is not a systematic process, causing the belief that learning itself is systematic. Learning is internally-generated and not an externally–imposed system. Analysis and presentation of language data items in a



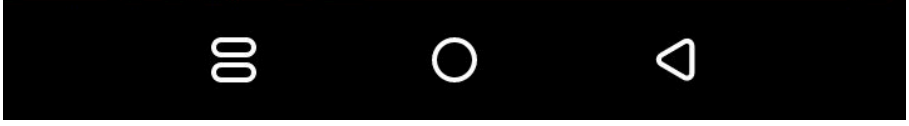


So in any course the need is what Hutchinson says: to give what the learner lacks. One should o know what the learner knows already so that what he/she lacks can be determined. The gap between target proficiency and existing proficiency is called the learners' "lack". A main part of a mmunication needs analysis is finding out how good the learners' language use is, what is their current mmunicative competence? Using of placement tests which have validity, face validity, authenticity, iable, is important. Wants are learners own view of what they "want" from the course, which might be conflict with the course and the instructor's perceptions of learners' necessities and lacks.

pic- 029: Analyzing Learning Needs

Learning needs can be analyzed by using different tools to collect a series of snapshots which ow them to compare a target situation with the current situation, thus leading to a focused course. After thering information through forms, questionnaires, interviews, observation tests etc. the teacher has to alyze learners' needs. The data acquired does not produce a sharply defined list of things to do, so it comes more difficult as the course progresses. A needs analysis provides a series of snapshots which ntribute to our understanding. It differentiates a General English course from ESP course and provides

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4:59

Question # 2 of 10 (Start time: 08:29:53 PM, 23 May 2023)

In a business English class, the possible problem(s) may include:

Select the correct option

- Interruptions
- materials
- distractions
- All of the given options

interrup 2 of 10

teacher should check the layout beforehand, furniture in rows, U-shaped Small groups? To set up and test equipment: e.g. video camera, Slide projector, Whiteboard pens. Shoddy equipment, a broken monitor can easily ruin the success of the course. Environment matters a lot for the success of a course - heating, ventilation, light, noise. A course conducted in a posh hotel will provide a different kind of experience than one conducted in the depth of a private school or the spare conference room of an organization. For group work, e.g. negotiations, the availability of other areas, lounge area, foyer is another aspect for course success.

3. The Venue - although the training room is key, it is not the only place where teachers and learners will spend their time. The teacher should sure that appropriate care is taken with planning for free time (social event for newcomers to build group rapport and get relaxed). Finally the teacher should know who the relevant people of the organization are and where to find them in case of a problem

4. Contingency plans - should be thought of in case anything goes wrong, e.g. interruptions, distractions, materials, or guest speakers who fail to arrive, venue problems (double booked, dirty, inappropriate food), illness.

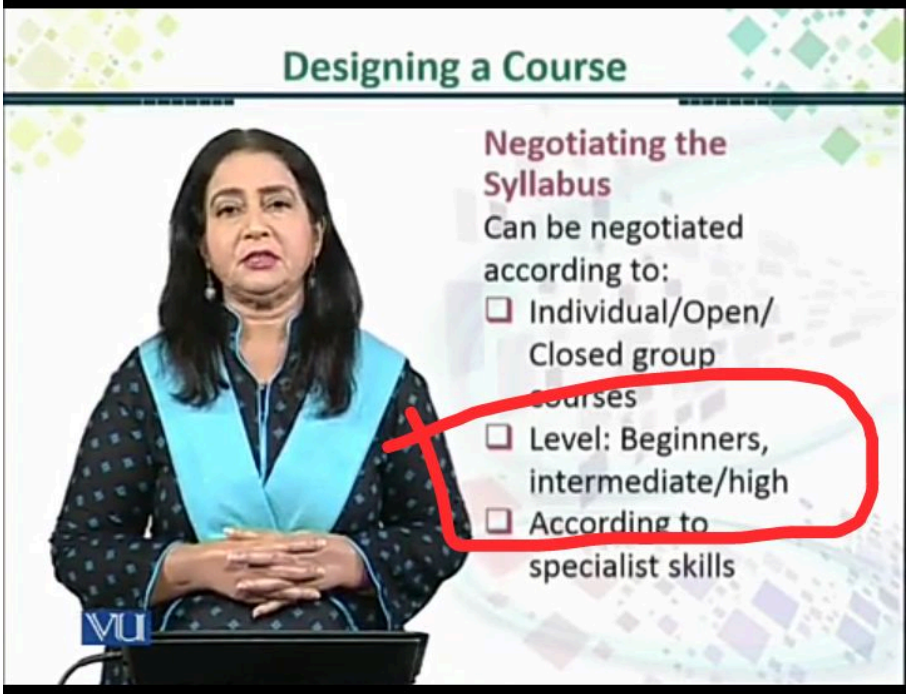
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Question # 3 of 10 (Start time: 08:47:02 PM, 23 May 2023)

In business English communication, syllabus can be negotiated according to_____.

Select the correct option

- intermediate
- beginners
- high
- all the given options ✓



4:49

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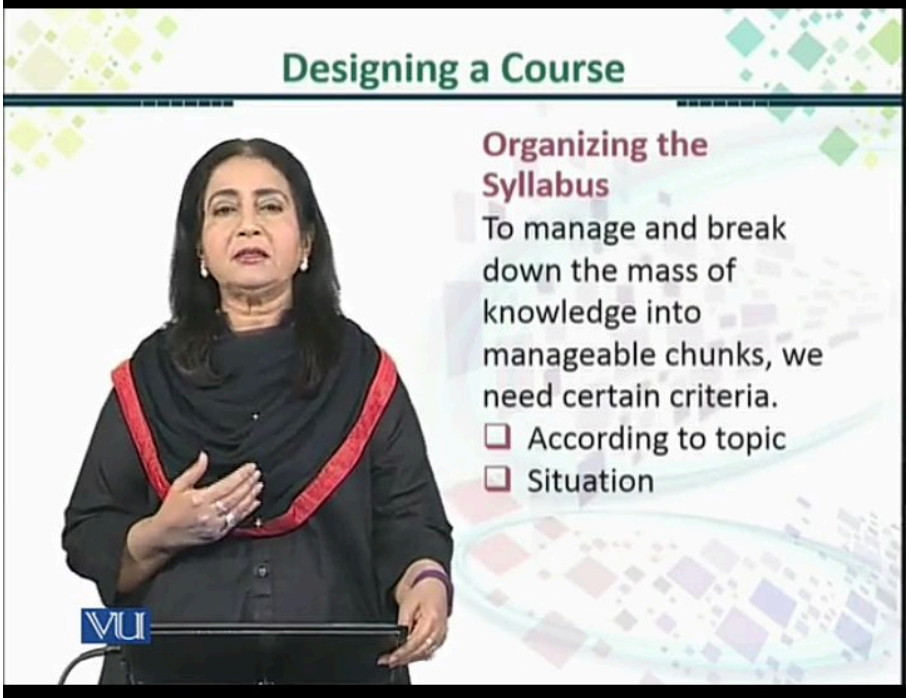
ENG516 - Teaching Business Communication (Quiz 1)

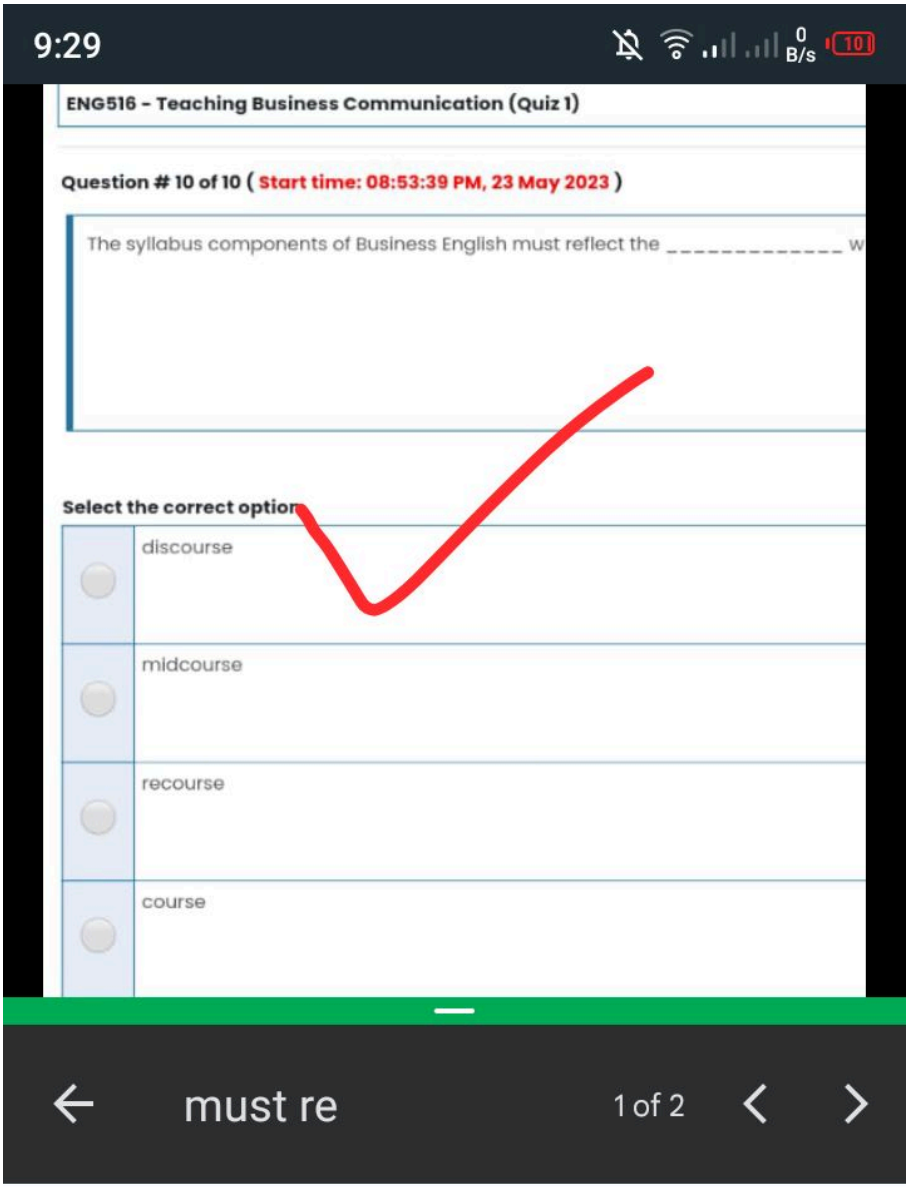
Question # 9 of 10 (Start time: 08:53:00 PM, 23 May 2023)

In business English, to manage and break down the mass of knowledge into manageable
_____.

Select the correct option

- situation
- all the given options
- skills and strategies
- topic





assessed and how you will be giving feedback. The syllabus states the actions to be taken in order to achieve the aims and objectives. It lists what is to be covered during the course and states an order.

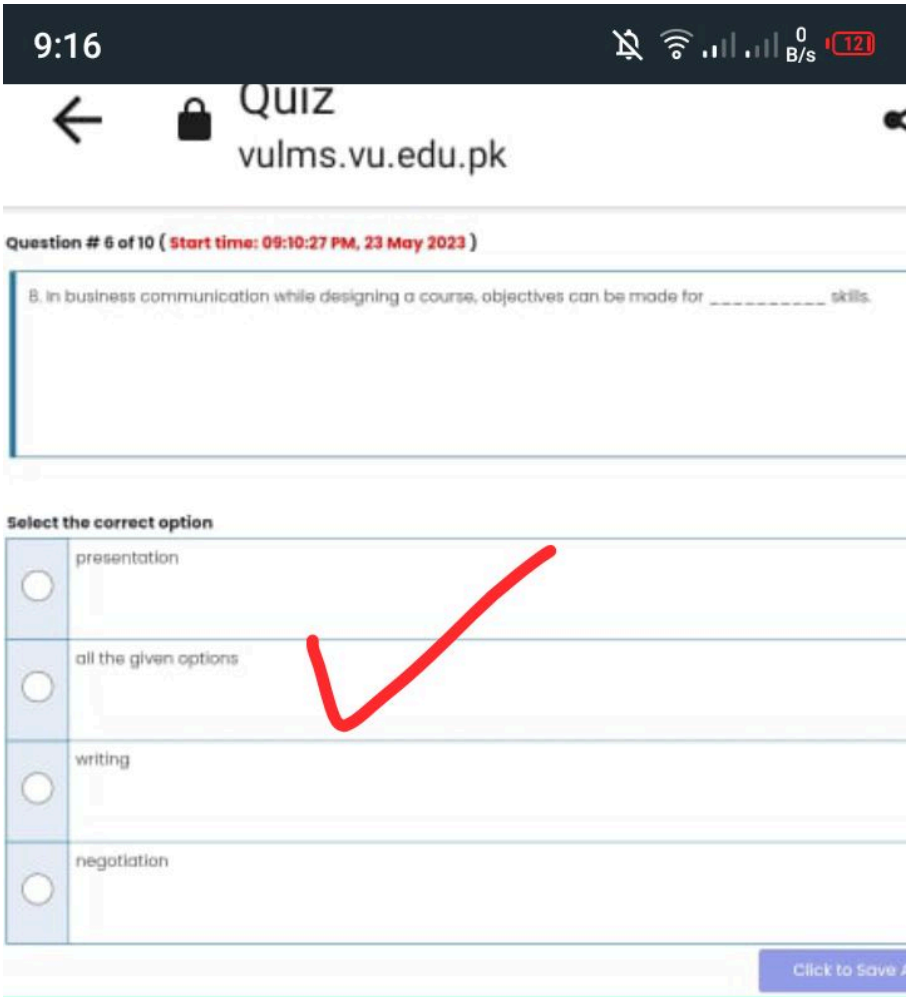
The syllabus can be re-negotiated at any time. Sometimes, in the middle of a course, a student asks for help because he/she needs to prepare a presentation for an unexpected trip. It usually is a very dynamic syllabus and you need to be flexible enough to adapt to new and changeable circumstances.

Topic- 044: Syllabus Components

Business English students need to communicate within a certain context, so the syllabus must reflect the discourse they are confronted within their workplace. For efficiency, teachers must ensure that the exposure to useful language is not random. So, the course designer's job includes finding the most common language forms that will help the learner to communicate and planning when and how the learner will encounter them. Students in the corporate finance field and usually have to present figures and results in English, so including the following components in the syllabus, are important:

- Dealing with numbers and figures
- Describing trends
- Corporate finance vocabulary
- Understanding and producing financial reports
- Giving presentations

Content items are words, structures, topics and process items like tasks, methods. Syllabus components should reflect topics, themes, situations and define types of assessments, and design learning activities and tasks. The syllabus should provide contact information to the instructor, list office hours (virtual office hours if possible, which includes tome spend in marking), and state the current academic term. It should include the authors and titles of prescribed books, list all assignments, quizzes exams, include course schedule, departmental requirements. The learning activities and tasks which help learners



teacher to go at his/her own pace, time, content and approach.

For 'Business Communication in English' for open group course or a *public group*, participants come from a wide audience and from a wide range of areas. In such a general BE course or executive English course participants will come from perhaps, geographical, corporate and professional areas. The trainer needs to be careful to fulfill the diverse objectives of such a group and have them agree on the objectives.

Close group course should be more or less a homogenous group of learners. Learners may be from same company, same professional function, same department, easiest in terms of objectives. Objectives can be made for meeting skills/ negotiation skills, presentation skills, writing skills, telephoning etc.

Objectives are not written in stone to be slavishly followed. It is an ongoing, interactive process. A learning centered approach will allow the designer to add and amend the course at any stage. Reflective practice is particularly important. The teacher and trainer keeps on thinking about ways of improving practice and incorporating these into future objectives. To be negotiated in beginning and during the course, regular feedback sessions will bring out trainees' strengths and weaknesses.

9:11

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NG516 - Teaching Business Communication (Quiz 1) Quiz Start Time: 09:04 PM, 23 May

uestion # 5 of 10 (Start time: 09:08:32 PM, 23 May 2023) Total Ma

While designing a course of business communication, it is important to be aware of _____ current performance ability in the target area before designing course objectives.

elect the correct option

- learners'
- examiners'
- parents'
- teachers'

Click to Save Answer & Move to Next Questio



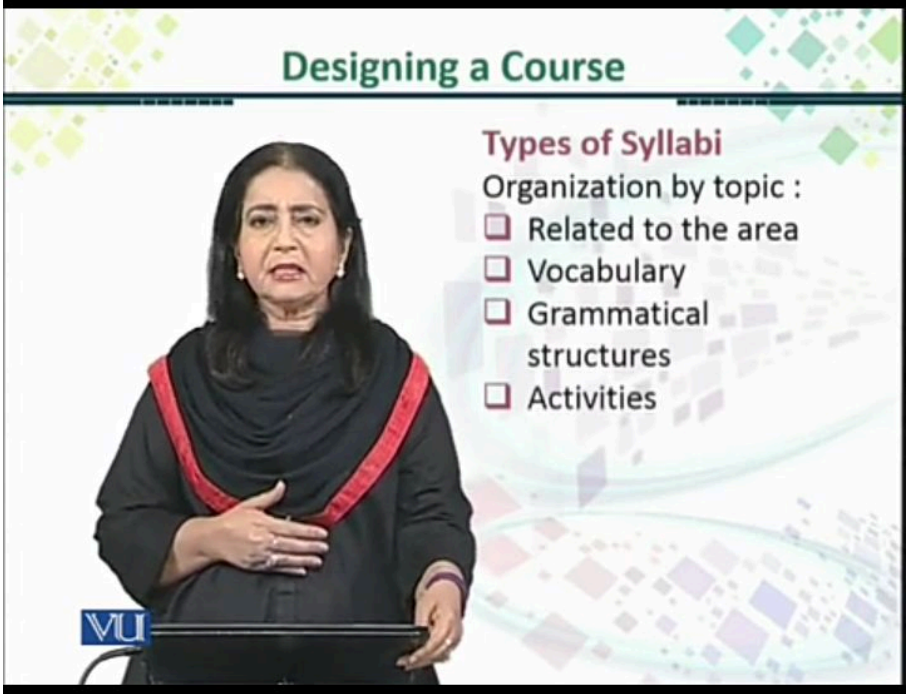
ENG516 - Teaching Business Communication (Quiz 1)

Question # 9 of 10 (Start time: 05:39:16 PM, 23 May 2023)

In business English, a syllabus organized topic wise covers:

Select the correct option

- activities
- vocabulary
- all the given options
- related area



8:33

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ENG516 - Teaching Business Communication (Quiz 1) Quiz Star

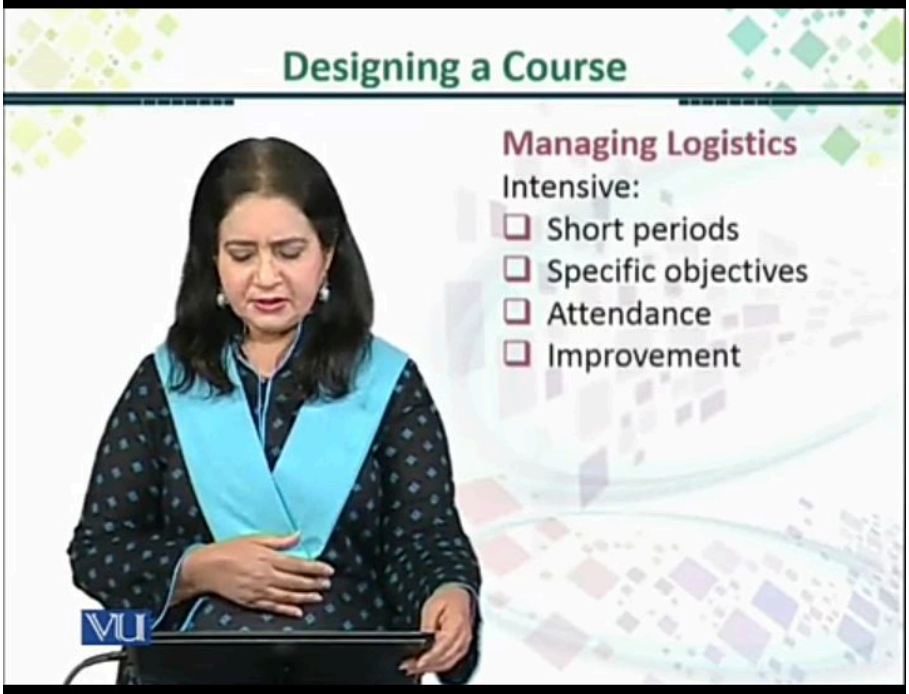
Question # 4 of 10 (Start time: 06:25:20 PM, 23 May 2023)

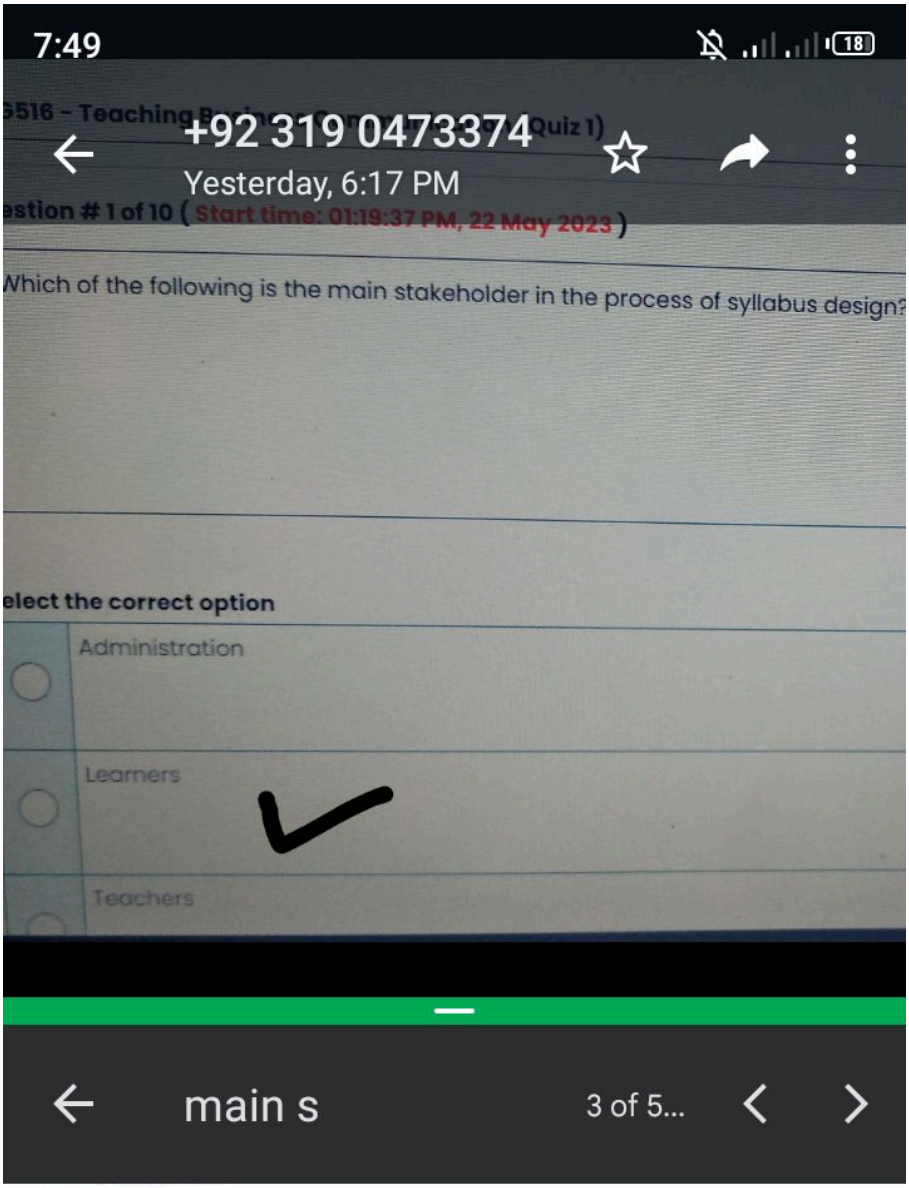
In business English communication teaching, an intensive course is designed for:

Select the correct option

- Specific objectives
- Improvement
- short periods
- a, b & c

Click to Save Answ





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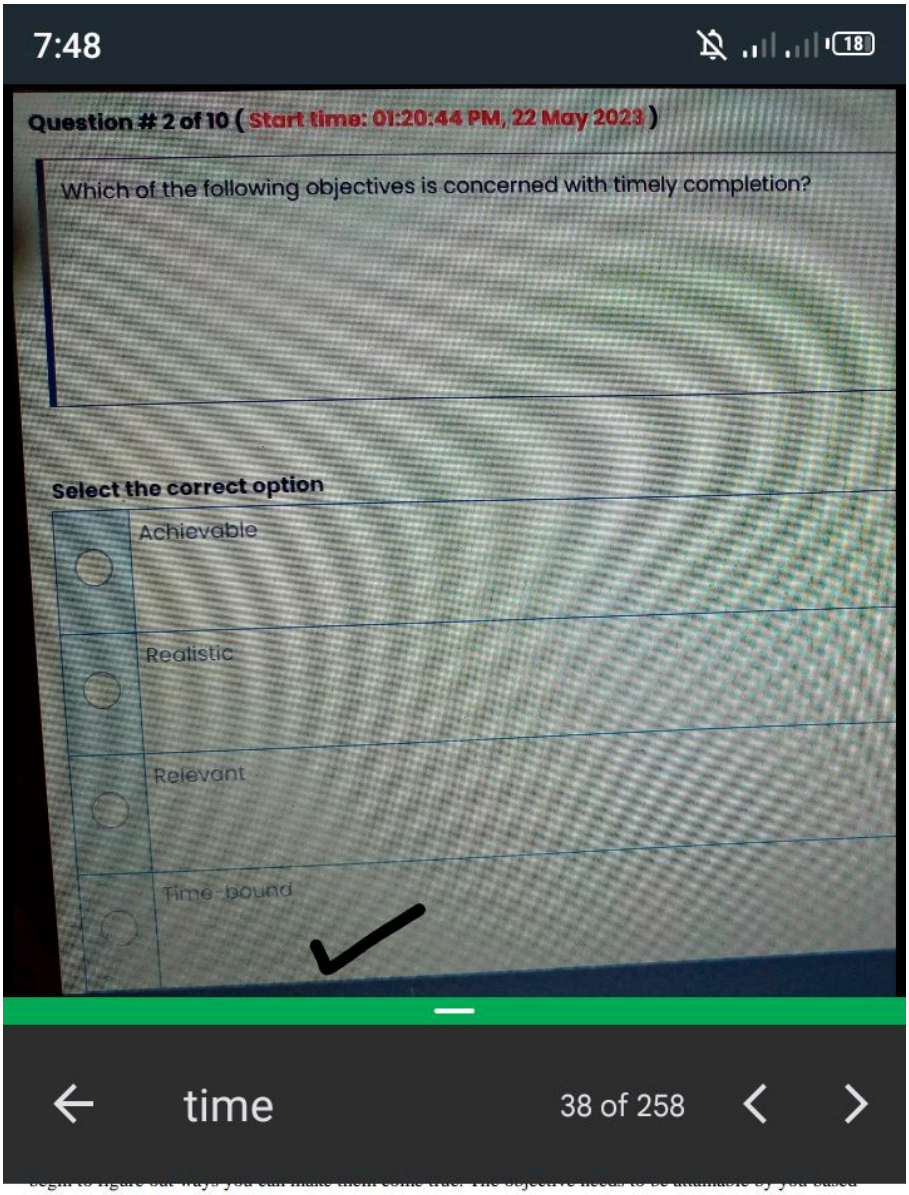
Negotiating priorities - this time, the aim is to guide learners towards a possible syllabus by suggesting possible options. A variation on this is to give learners different options during the course: do they want to do this or that next week? Teachers might allow learners to develop their own tasks and activities. For example, if the course is covering presentation skills, the learners could make decisions about the topics of their own presentations, or the length, or the criteria for succ... ...proa... emphasizes the need for consensus and compromise, which are important element

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Topic- 050: Using Learner's Input

Since the learners are the main stakeholders in the process, their input is crucial. It gives insight to the teacher about the pace of the course and course content. The teacher can give the class a questionnaire to fill questions about their own preferences, and then pass the sheets around so that everyone can see what their colleagues want and do not want and can understand that different people have different needs. This information is then used as the basis for a third question, the answer to which is

in effect, the syllabus as generated by the group. It will be an amalgam of the different priorities that have surfaced. Generating the syllabus in this way brings home to the learners that what may happen is actually a compromise. Getting them to sign at the bottom of the page is a useful way to remind them that they are

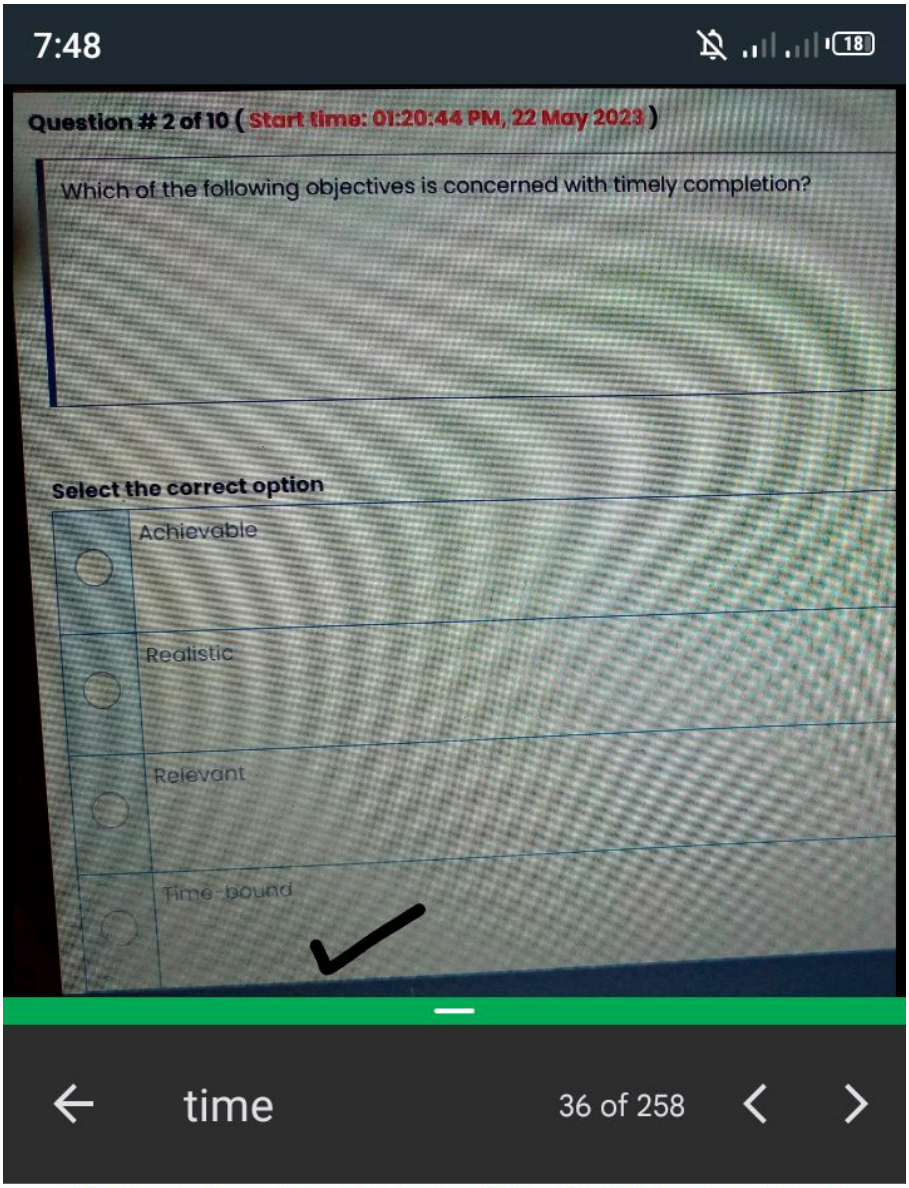


on the skills you have and the constraints imposed.

Relevant objectives in terms of leading to the desired results and relate to needs analysis, what is their current communicative proficiency and what they should be at the end of the course. This means two things; that the goal or target being set with the individual is something they can actually impact upon or change and secondly it is also important to the organization, and is relevant to what the organization is trying to achieve. The manager has to decide these objectives by considering the wider picture.

Time-bound Objectives are concerned with timely completion: When do you want to achieve the set objectives? When will we accomplish/ complete this objective? In the objective somewhere, there has to be a date (Day/Month/Year) for when the task has to be started (if it's ongoing) and/or completed (if it's short term or project related). Time-bound means setting deadlines for the achievement of the objective. Deadlines need to be both achievable and realistic. If you don't set a time, you will reduce the motivation and urgency required to execute the tasks. Agreed time frames create the necessary urgency and prompts action.

Topic- 040: Teaching and Business Objectives



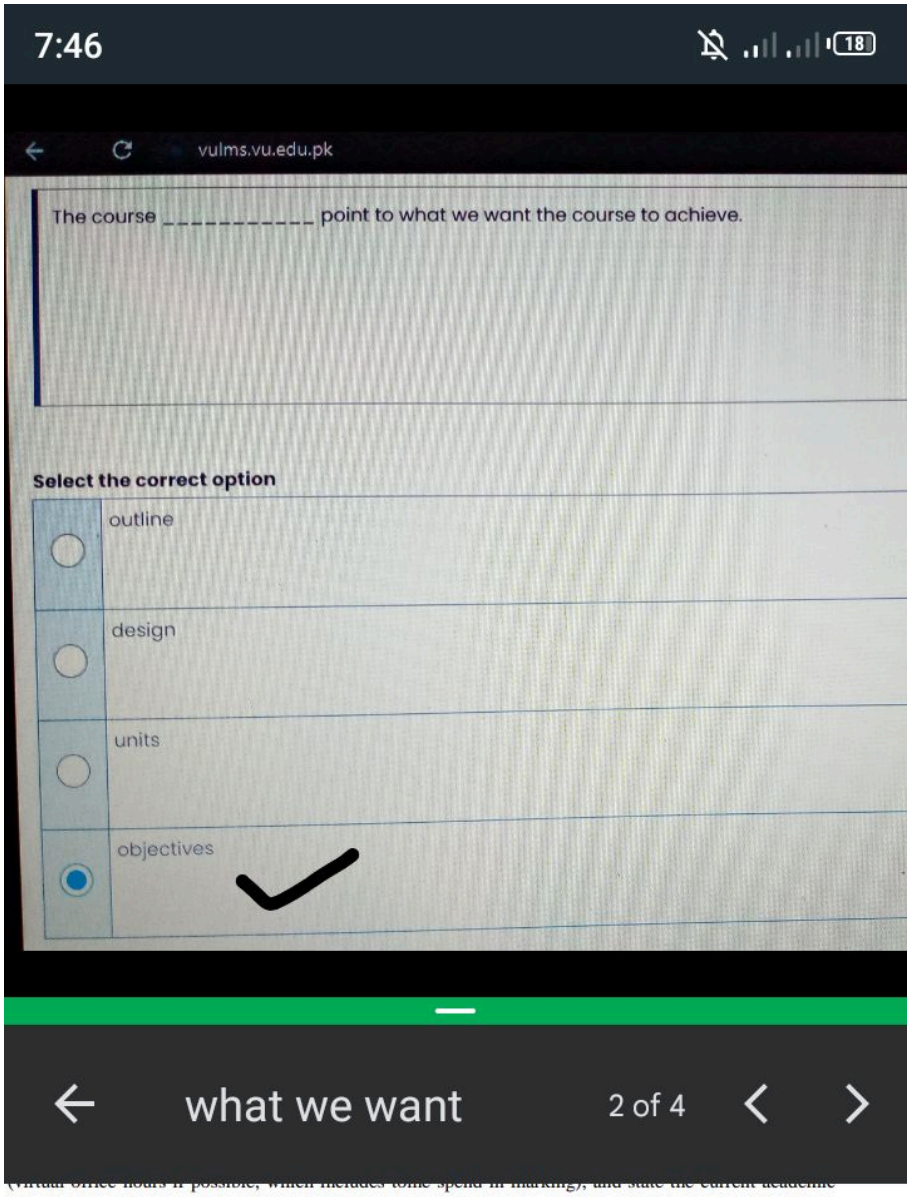
Many organizations are increasingly using the SMART and SMARTER acronym within goal setting and performance appraisal in management environments. The use of SMART objective is not limited to business and performance management, indeed SMART possibly started in the world of personal development. SMARTER is an acronym to help in the writing of objectives, which can be for managing performance or for developmental purposes. Objectives should be specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound, to specify what they need to achieve, answering six questions: Who? What? Where? When? Which? Why?

A specific objective has a much greater chance of being accomplished than a general goal. To set a specific objective you need to answer the six "W" questions: Who: Who is involved? What: What do I want to accomplish? Where: Identify a location. When: Establish a time frame. Which: Identify requirements and constraints. Why: Specific reasons, purpose or benefits of accomplishing the goal. Instead of saying: "Awareness of …" it should be "Learners will be able to speak about the ..." Rules of conciseness and correctness should be applied.

Measureable objectives measure whether objectives are met or not. They establish concrete criteria for measuring progress toward the attainment of each objective you set. When you measure your progress, you stay on track, reach your target dates, and experience the feeling of achievement that drives you on to continued effort required to reach your objective. To determine if your objective is measurable, ask questions such *how much? How many? How will I know when it is accomplished?* If the objective is measurable, it means that the measurement source is identified and we are able to track the actions as we progress towards the objective. Measurement is the standard used for comparison. Measurements (and the visible progress) go a long way to help us to know when we have achieved our objective.

Achievable objectives see whether set objectives are achievable and attainable in terms of abilities, realistic facilities and logistics. When you identify objectives that are most important to you, you begin to figure out ways you can make them come true. The objective needs to be attainable by you based on the skills you have and the constraints imposed.

Relevant objectives in terms of leading to the desired results and relate to needs analysis, what is



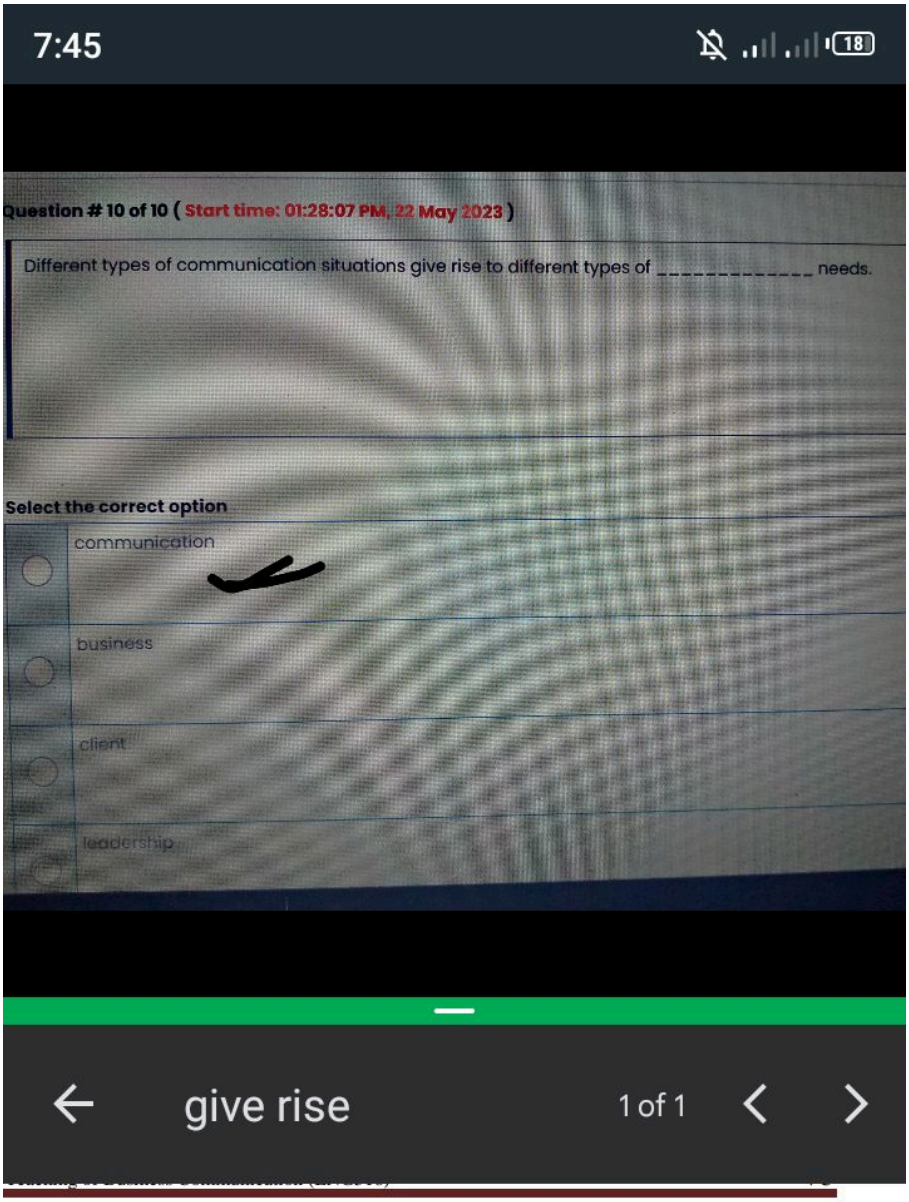
term. It should include the authors and titles of prescribed books, list all assignments, quizzes exams, include course schedule, departmental requirements. The learning activities and tasks which help learners develop their communicative competence – linguistic, socio-cultural and pragmatic.

Those language items are selected which the learner needs to know and concentrate on the content and the meaning of the interactions. A syllabus can be organized in various ways: According to topic, task or around activities, such as presentations, negotiations and telephoning.

Topic- 045: What is to be Covered and in what Order

The course objectives point to what we want the course to achieve. Once we know what we want to achieve, we can move on to thinking about the syllabus. A syllabus is, essentially, a list of what is to be covered and in what order. The course should focus on the language needed. In Business English teaching the focus should be on using language to perform tasks, not just to talk about it. Most Business English learners needed to be able to communicate within a certain context, so the syllabus must reflect the discourse that the learner will face in the workplace.

The language needs to be learnable, and according to the level of the learners. Learning must be achievable in the time provided, e.g. it is unrealistic to suggest that a complete beginner will be able to take part in complex negotiations after a week's teaching.



Lesson 06

NEEDS ANALYSIS-II

Topic - 031: Communication Needs

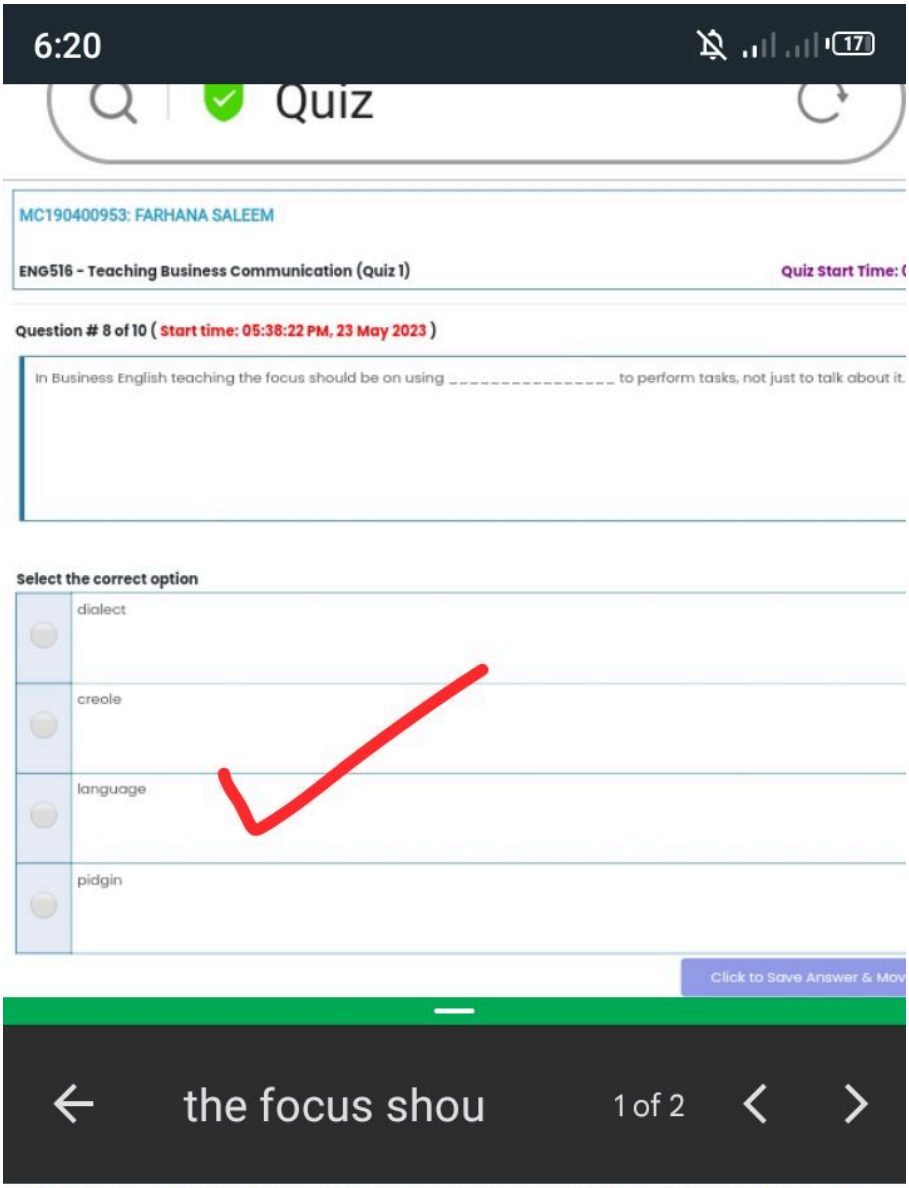
Before we start teaching a course there is certain information which we need to have in the shape of needs analysis which includes communication needs, business needs and pedagogical needs of learners and teachers. Information is of two types. First: Target situation and types of discourse. Second: Current competence – to find the gap – on which depends the syllabus objectives.

Different types of communication situations give rise to different types of communication needs. A modern organization uses a range of communication channels - traditional like letters and reports and the telephone as well as modern like the internet, intranet, fax, instant messages etc.

To analyze communication needs of learners is to find out as much as possible about what the learners of the course will need to do in English. For example, learners working in a business organization may need to be able to use the telephone with English- speaking clients, or they may need to travel to other countries in order to sell their product. Students in a BE course would need to be able to write assignments in their core courses area. Students engaged in research would need writing skills to write their dissertation.

Needs analysis also aims to find out the different areas and styles of discourse that learners might engage in. This will not only give a better idea about the target situation, but will also address the teacher's own need to understand what the learners actually do with the language. Communicative competence has several layers, of which language is only one.

A variety of tools can be used, including questionnaires, interviews, and observation. Many schools provide teachers forms and charts to carry out needs analysis. Commercially available tests are



include course schedule, departmental requirements. The learning activities and tasks which help learners develop their communicative competence – linguistic, socio-cultural and pragmatic.

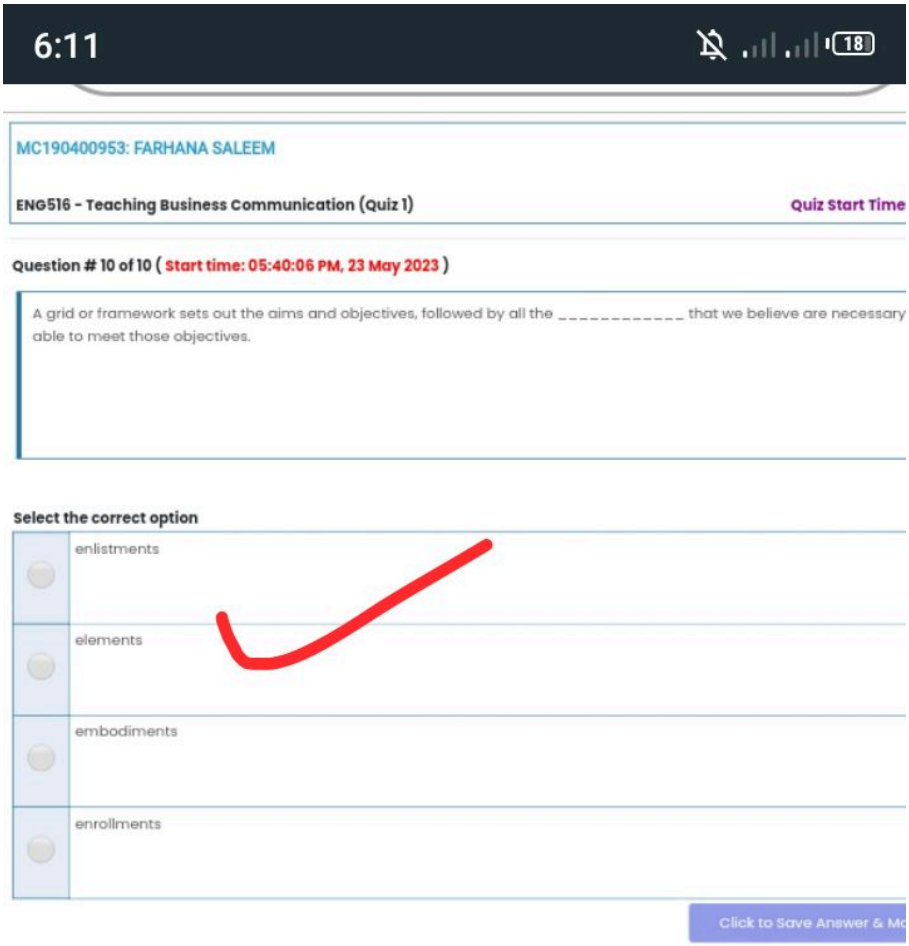
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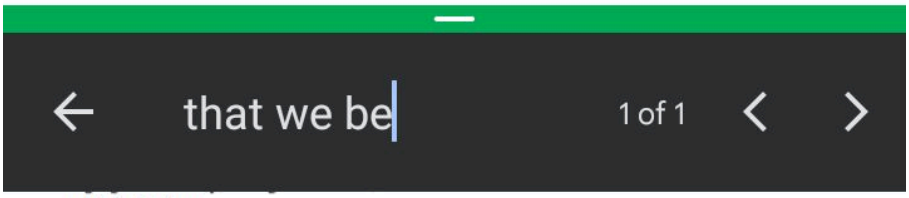
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and their situation.

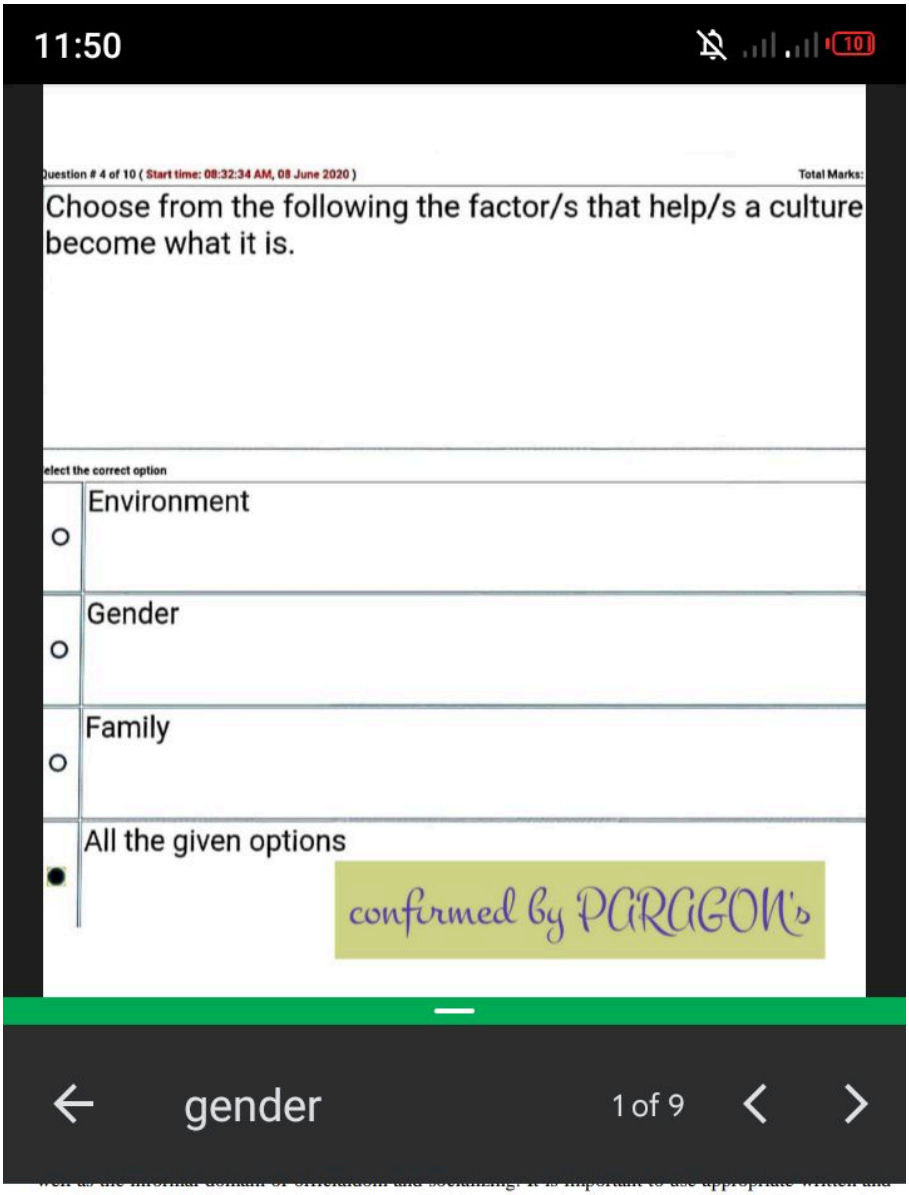
Topic- 046: Using a Grid

A useful technique is to use a grid or framework in making a syllabus. A grid or framework sets out the aims and objectives, followed by all the elements that we believe are necessary for someone to be able to meet those objectives. The main components of this framework are based on the competencies identified as: Linguistic competence (Language based), Discourse competence (identification of possible discourse learners will encounter, specialist knowledge) and Intercultural competence (communication needs in international business/educational environment).

The syllabus will take into account not only what is to be learnt but how it is to be learnt and how it will be assessed in terms of achieving course objectives, using the guidelines offered by communicative language teaching and the insights gained through the needs analysis. Grids normally consist of a combination of the following components, sometimes called threads, because they weave through the course and could be seen as holding it together:

- Grammar (e.g. tenses, word order, verb patterns, relative clauses)
- Lexis (e.g. vocabulary, idioms, expressions, collocations)
- Pronunciation (e.g. intonation, rhythm, stress, chunking)
- Functions (e.g. complaining, agreeing, persuading, explaining)
- Business skills (e.g. presenting, negotiating, telephoning, socializing)
- Topics (e.g. finance, marketing, production, management)
- Learning strategies (e.g. learning styles, recording vocabulary, preparing for a test)
- Situations (e.g. assisting visitors, checking into a hotel, running a meeting)
- Texts (e.g. examples of spoken or written discourse)
- Language skills (e.g. reading, writing, listening, speaking)
- Intercultural skills (defining, comparing culture)
- Storyline approach (materials have characters for the storyline)
- Tasks (learners use language to do something and achieve an outcome

At the end, there is a column for methodology and timings.

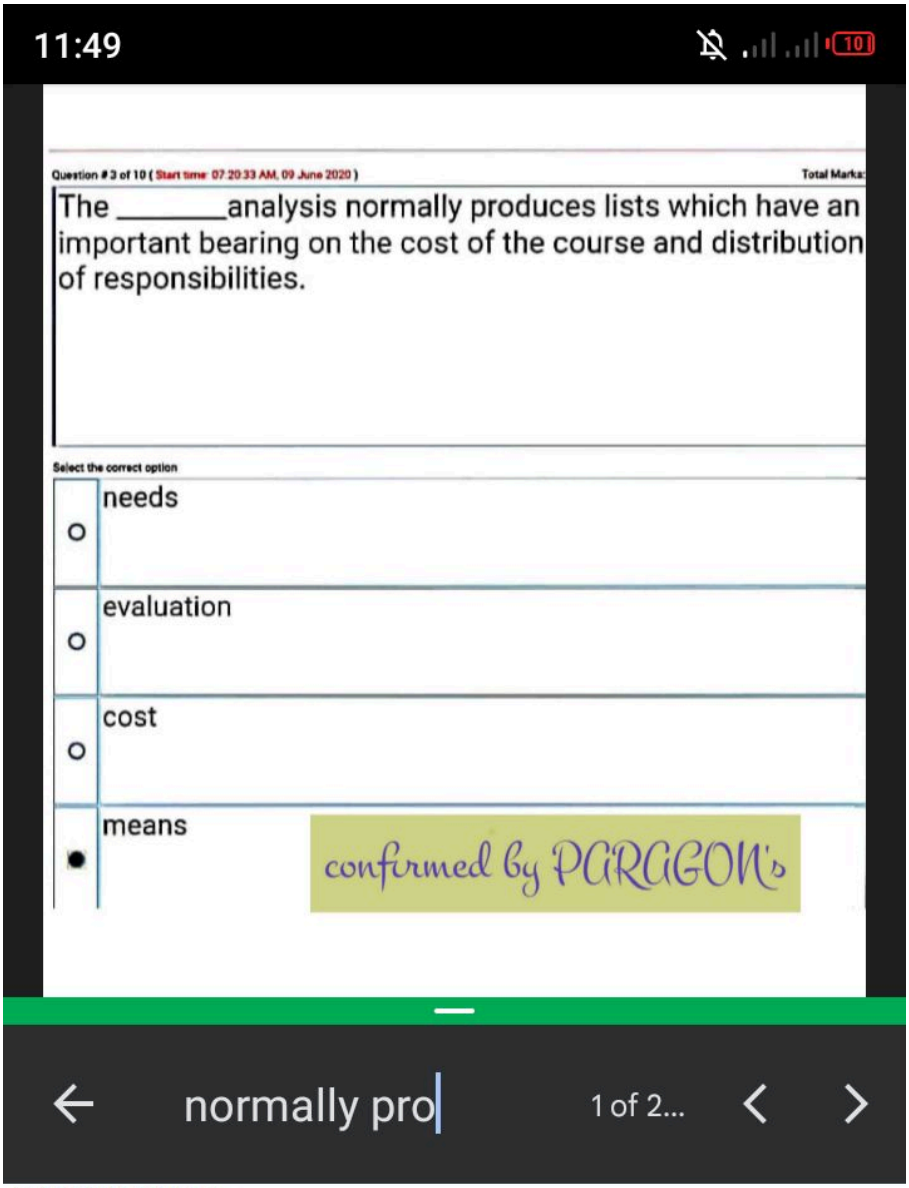


spoken language here.

Topic- 015: Intercultural Competence

The Business Communication learner will have to be familiarized to the intercultural aspect of communication. In the globalized world of today where international education, business and tourism has been made easier through cheaper and faster means of communication, there is need for the business communicator to be culturally sensitive. Businesses are carried out with multinational companies and TNCs. At the computer interface as well, culturally sensitive language is required. Culture has to do with attitudes, behaviors, beliefs, and values. It is influenced by a multitude of factors including environment, society, gender, family, age, and ethics. It is learned, not inherited through genes. It manifests itself in interaction between people, and is continually changing. Some cultural differences are superficial, and are relatively simple to deal with. It is easy to see that people may dress or eat differently, for example cultural differences are not always so obvious. The iceberg model is often used to demonstrate how much of culture is hidden. Like an iceberg with most of its bulk unseen below the surface of the water, these hidden aspects can cause problems if we are not aware of them and don't know how to deal with them.

There are different types of cultures. National culture takes as its reference point the concept of the politically bounded nation state. This is not the same as ethnicity, which is used to refer to groups having the same language, history, religion, or race. A nation may be composed of different ethnic groups, and ethnic groups do not always observe national borders. Organizational or corporate culture describes the specific behaviors and values found in organizations. So, for example, a young company with twenty employees which sells groceries via the internet is likely to have a very different way of doing things compared to an older, more traditional engineering company which has been in existence for over a hundred years, and which has more than 300,000 employees scattered in different parts of the world. Professions also have their own distinct cultures. We might expect doctors and musicians to



learning styles of learners.

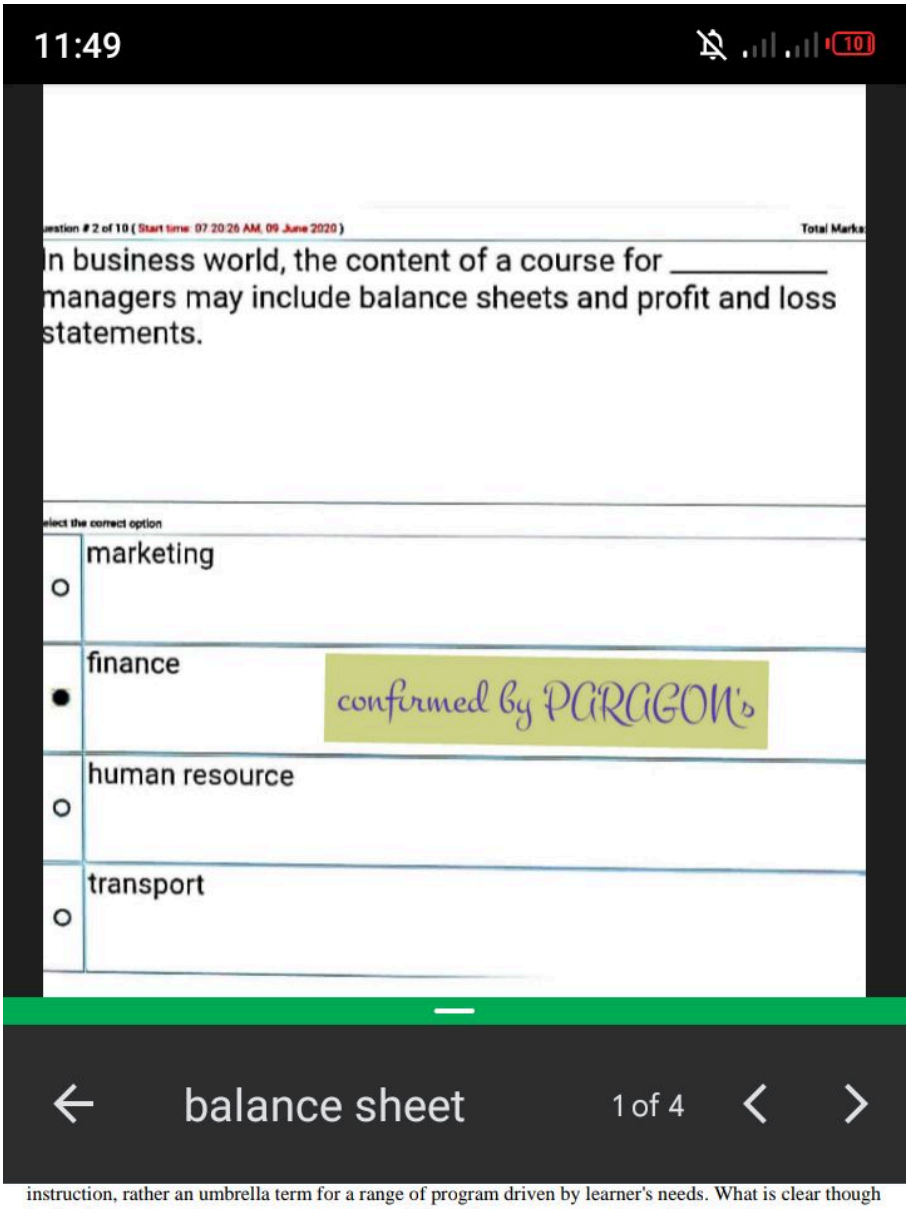
Teacher's Needs: What happens in the classroom is influenced to a very great extent by the trainer's own style, experience, and needs. An important part of a needs analysis depends on teachers' basic assumptions about teaching and learning. The BE teacher is basically a language expert, not a specialist in the core area, having experience in teaching general English. When teaching business English, the teacher has to adapt his/her learning style, and use strategies which can be passed on to learners. Being a reflective practitioner and having self-knowledge about own learning style is important. Teachers' role can be of trainer, coach and consultant.

A means analysis is a description of the training environment: what is available in terms of equipment, materials, facilities, and time. Means analysis normally produces lists which have an important bearing on the cost of the course and distribution of responsibilities. It entails looking at matters of coordination, availability, timings and preparation. Means analysis involves reflecting on key issues and personal/professional targets along the cline and methods for achieving them. Needs analysis is about making ongoing evaluations.

Topic- 034: Language Styles

Learning success depends on a number of factors. There are a number of different ways to look at learning styles. One is based on the findings of research into brain function, that the right and left sides of the brain play different roles in how we process information. Depending on which side of their brain is dominant, there are the 'left-brain' learners who tend to analyze, and to be logical and objective. They may prefer traditional lectures, reading, and clearly structured classroom activities and 'Right-brain' learners tend to be more impulsive and informal, and may appreciate the use of graphics and role-play activities to enhance their learning.

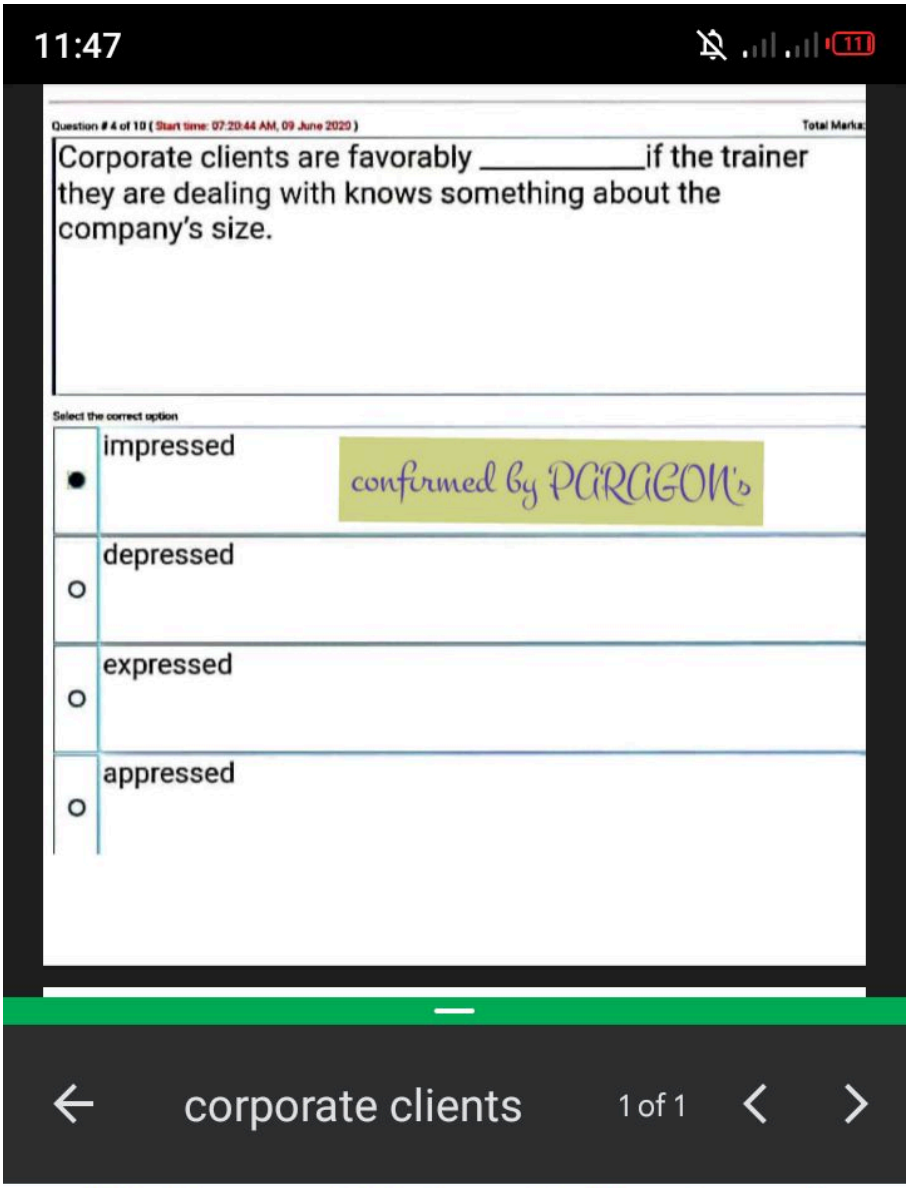
Learning styles are related to NLP (Neuro-Linguistic Programming), which is a collection of techniques, models, and theories based on how the mind works and how people behave and communicate. NLP has been useful to some business English teachers because of the insight it gives into various



instruction, rather an umbrella term for a range of program driven by learner's needs. What is clear though is that language teachers are not content specialists. They cannot be expected to provide management training within the guise of language training.

The Role of the Language Teacher in the Business Classroom: At one end of the continuum are courses which focus on language teaching (focusing on language development within a framework of business oriented vocabulary). On the other end, programs which combine content, language and communication to develop learners' language knowledge and communication skills. The BC teacher is not a management, financial expert but rather a knowledgeable generalist, able to tap into learner's expertise and use it as a resource in the development of the course. For a course for finance managers who need to develop their language knowledge and communication skills for handling communication and exchanges on professional matters, the content may include balance sheets and profit and loss statements. The course prepared for them, depending on their needs and the trainers' skill may include the following: Developing language knowledge (professional communication skills, specialist language knowledge, and professional language skills) within the context of general business and financial topics. Key issues for reflection are:

- Personal/professional targets along the cline
- Methods for achieving them
- Organization in Business
- Types of companies: public/private, etc.
- Management and management activities: The key functions in business organizations (departmental)
- The main sectors in which businesses operate

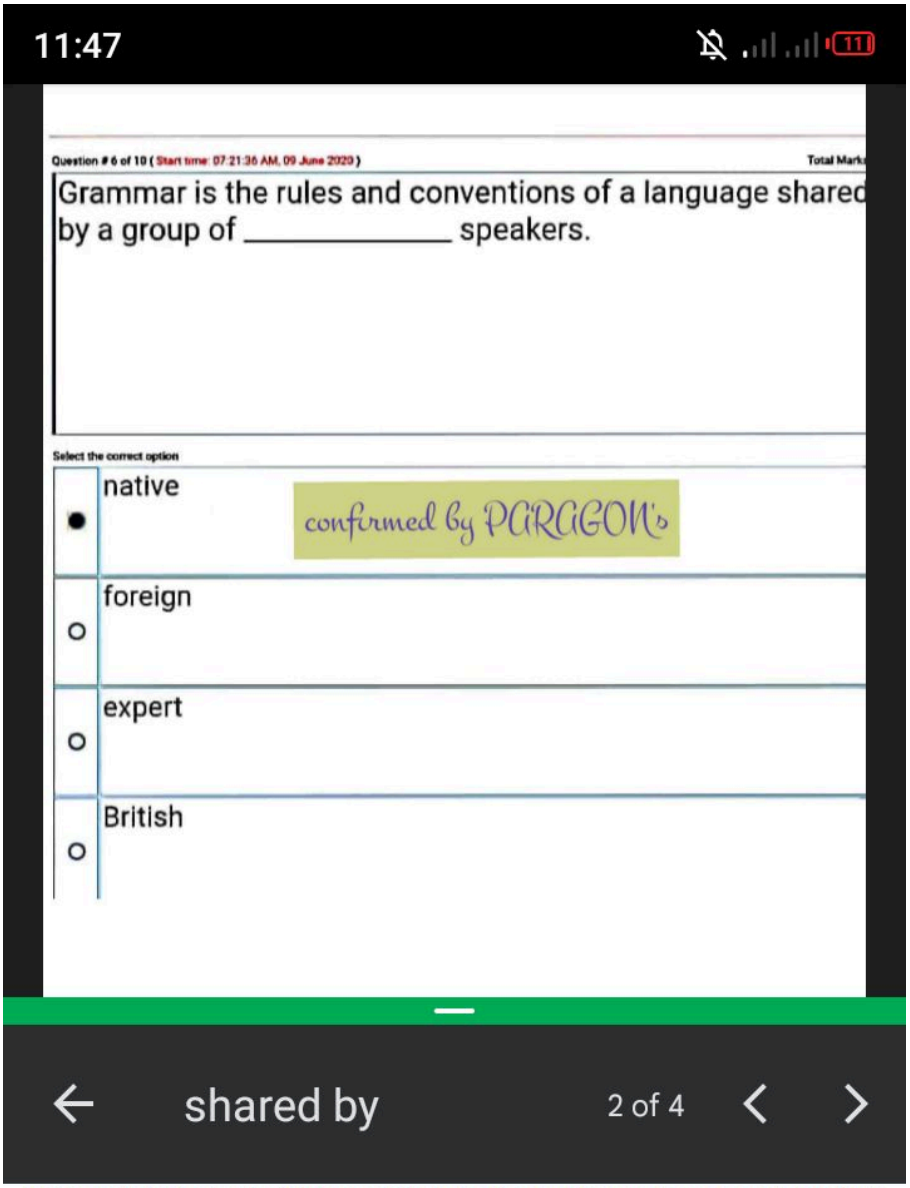


Understanding business needs is of critical importance for a BE teacher. A provider of language training must consider the needs of the sponsor, who may be a company, or a head of department, or the HR (Human Resources) manager. All of these have certain perspectives on what the learners will need to cover on a course. It is important to make it clear to sponsors and heads that their needs are recognized and will be addressed, while remaining realistic about what is promised. Businesses are interested in getting something worthwhile for their money. A company pays for training or an institution hires a teacher because it feels that the investment will lead to some sort of profit, be it more motivated workers, more effective negotiators, better presenters, managers, or high achieving students.

One way for the teacher is to understand business needs and learn about the company. This means doing some research. Ideally, this is done before starting to meet people. Corporate clients are favorably impressed if the trainer or language school they are dealing with knows something about the company's product, the market, and its size. With the internet, this is relatively easy to do but there are also limitations. Reading an annual report will give one perspective, but such documents are designed to tempt investors. Websites which are open to the public may not have all the details a teacher needs. At this stage, some basic information is needed, so that when we enter the company and start talking to people, we can demonstrate our professionalism and ask the right questions.

Business English teachers needed to understand the various business functions of those involved. The perspective of the engineering department will be very different from that of people in the financial department. Product information is also important. The engineers who build mobile phones will have a very different perspective from the one we may have as a user. They will be interested in materials, technical specifications, and so on. The financial people will be more interested in the last auditors' report, and next week's balance sheet.

Company's hierarchy is important to be understood and the level of learners in the company hierarchy is also relevant. A high-level manager in a multinational corporation will not have the same needs as a person on the shop floor, even if they both have the same marks in a language placement test. The high level manager needs would be perhaps to polish his presentation skills, and he/she might be in



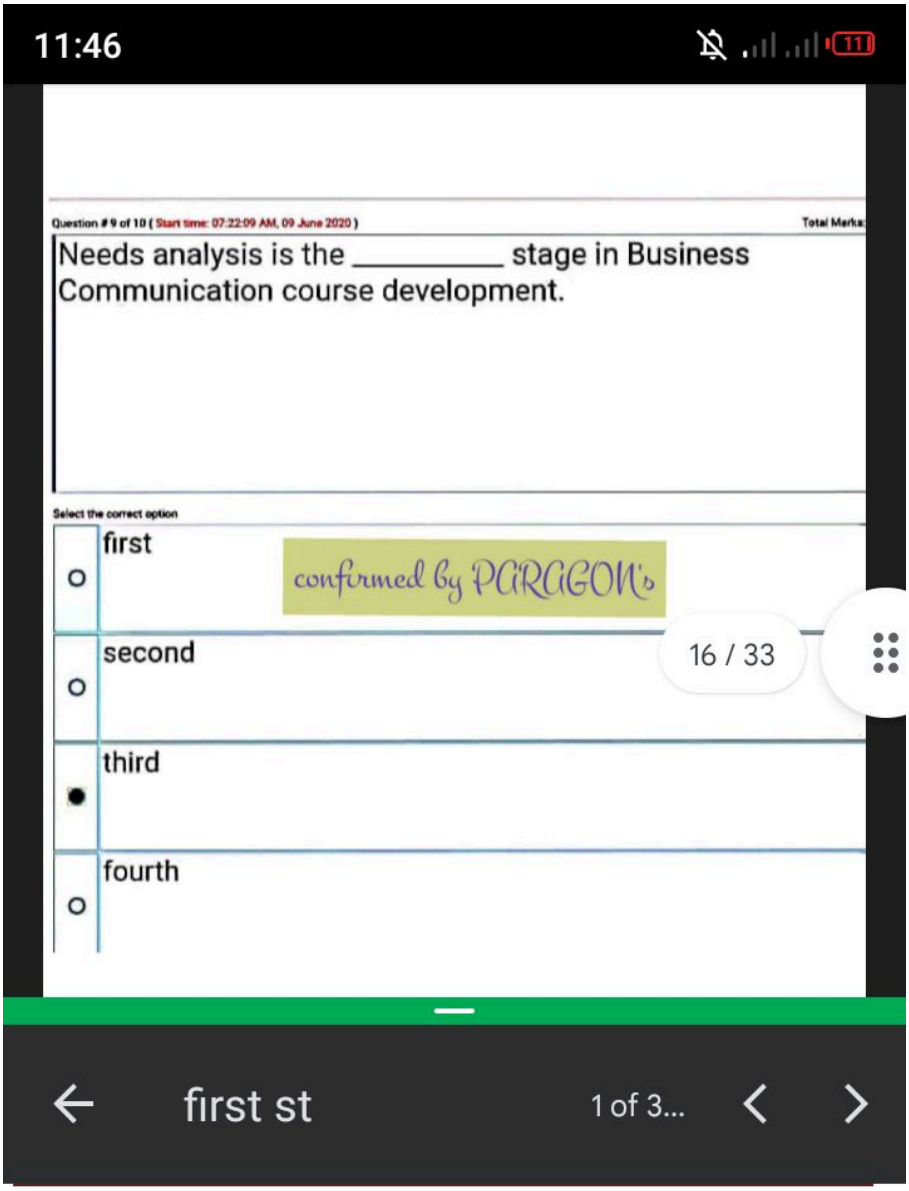
besides context-driven and topic driven vocabulary, there is a need for general purpose vocabulary. Long lists might be daunting for the learner, so they should be served in reasonable chunks. Checklists exist in various areas and can be helpful for the Business English teacher and learner.

Topic- 108: Grammar

Grammar is the set of rules and conventions of language shared by a group of native speakers (whereby we decide whether a particular language form is right or wrong). It gives out the structure of the categories of language (whereby learners study the A – Z of grammatical structures). Grammatical accuracy is in most cases black and white, making it clear whether a sentence or an utterance is right or wrong. However, there are grey areas which are related to specific varieties of a language. The question to be asked is, is there a need for a separate grammar for business English? Actually, there is no need for any language category specific to business communication, all the forms which exist in general English - nouns, verbs, prepositions, adverbs can be utilized.

However, it does seem that some grammatical forms are more prevalent than others. Language is neutral. A genre analysis of a business text would reveal the types of communicative acts which are used for particular communicative purposes. In business communication, this could include activities such as presentations, briefings, memos, promotional letters all recognized and classified according to

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Lesson 05

NEEDS ANALYSIS-I

Topic- 025: What are Needs? What are Target Needs?

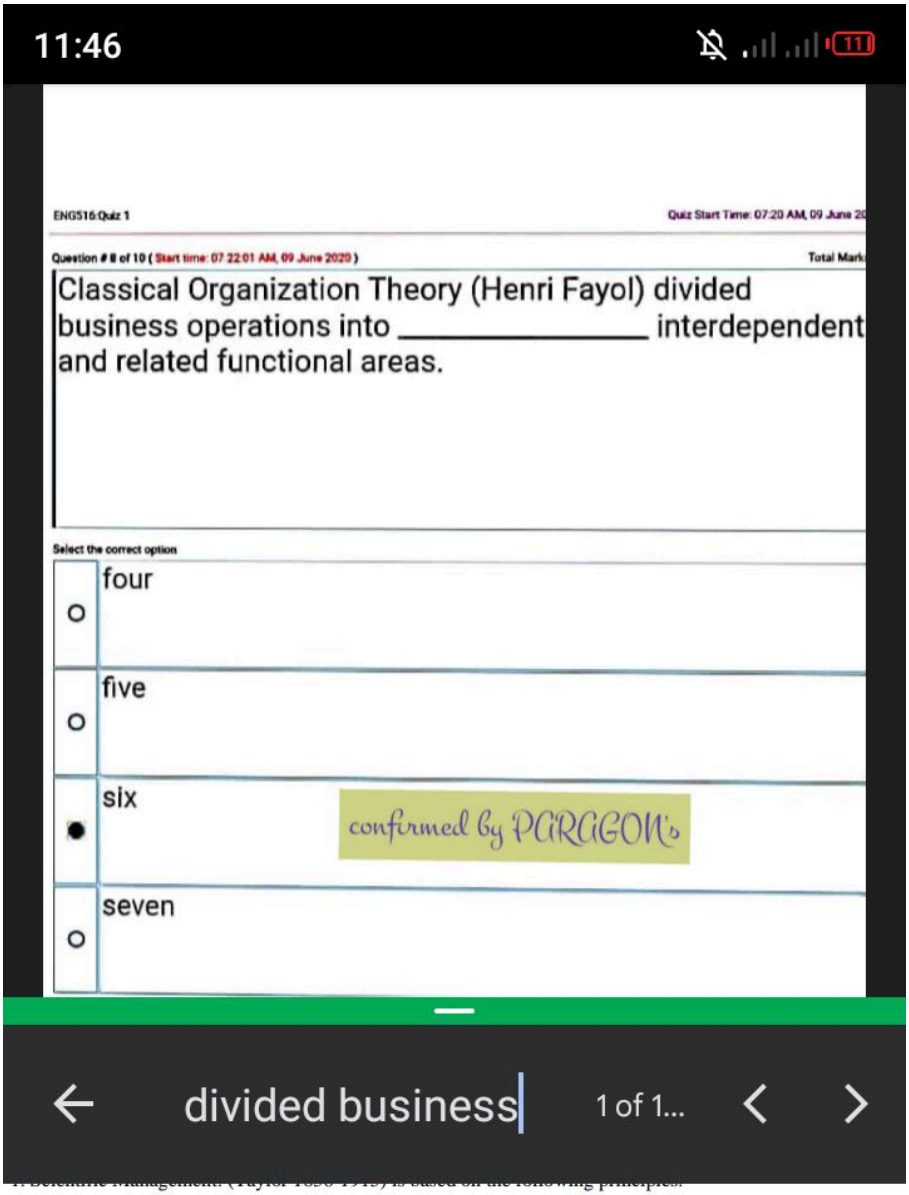
The difference between Business English (BE) and General English (GE) courses is basically that Business English aims to fulfill the needs of business and management students. What are these needs? The basic aim of a needs analysis is to collect and examine critically, information about the current situation (where the students are at present) and the target situation (where they would like to be at the end of the teaching).

Needs analysis, carried out to establish the "what" and the "how" of a course, is the first stage in Business Communication course development, followed by curriculum design, materials selection, methodology, assessment, and evaluation. However, these stages should not be seen as separate, but as proceeding in a linear fashion. They come at the pre-course stage. The teacher needs to know the needs of the learners so that the objectives of the course may be decided. Business English learners have more precisely defined needs than general English learners and these needs should be incorporated in the course objectives. It is useful to see the needs analysis stage as consisting of three separate but linked elements:

- The range of communication and language required in the learner's present of future profession.
- The current ability of the learner in terms of language and communication.
- The actual objective of the training program .

In order to find this we need to address the following questions:

- What type of information do we need to get?
- How can we get this information?



- Management as a science, best method
- Scientific selection of workers, so that each worker would be given responsibility for which he/she is best suited
- Scientific education and development of the worker
- Intimate, friendly relations between the worker and management

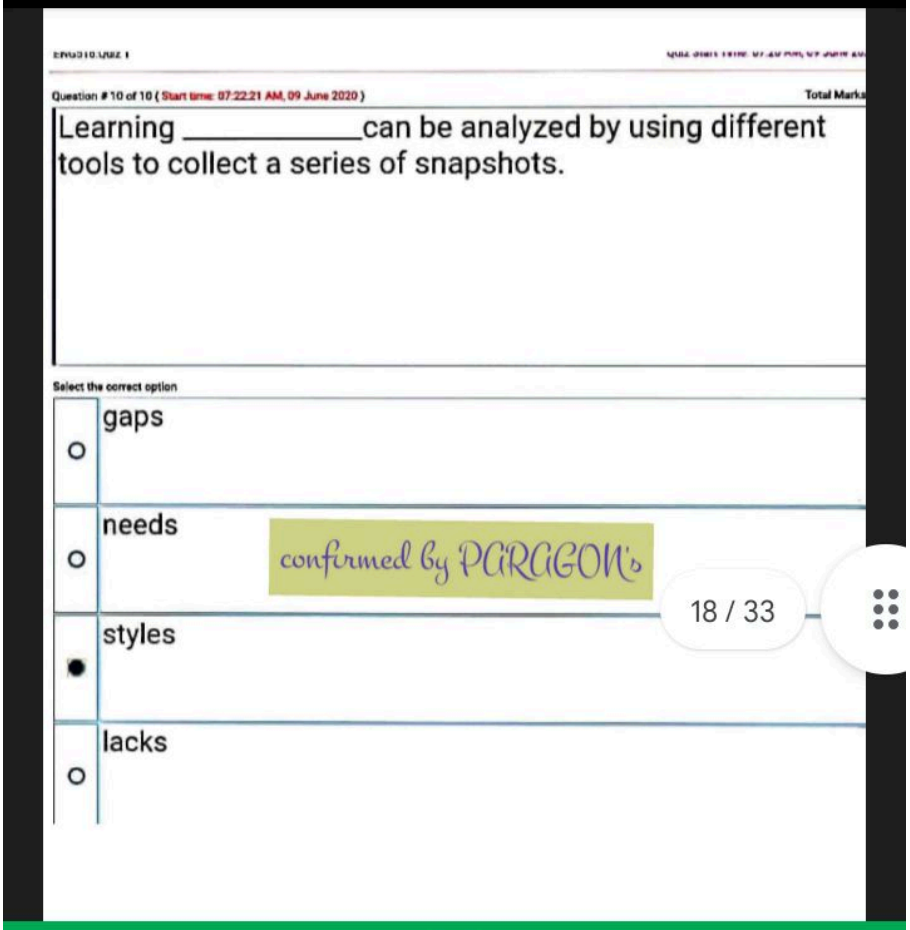
2. Classical Organization Theory (Henri Fayol 1841-1925) is based on the recognition of the human factor in management and on managerial behavior. He believed that management is not an inborn talent but a learnt skill. He divided business operations into six interdependent and related functional areas:

- Technical
- Commercial
- Financial
- Security
- Accounting
- Managerial

Superimposed on these was his view of what management was about and what skills are needed by the manager: These skills are:

- Planning
- Organizing
- Commanding
- Coordinating
- Controlling

3. Behavioral Movement: Managers get frustrated that people do not behave in predicted ways. The social sciences of psychology and sociology provide insights into human behavior in the workplace, resulting in

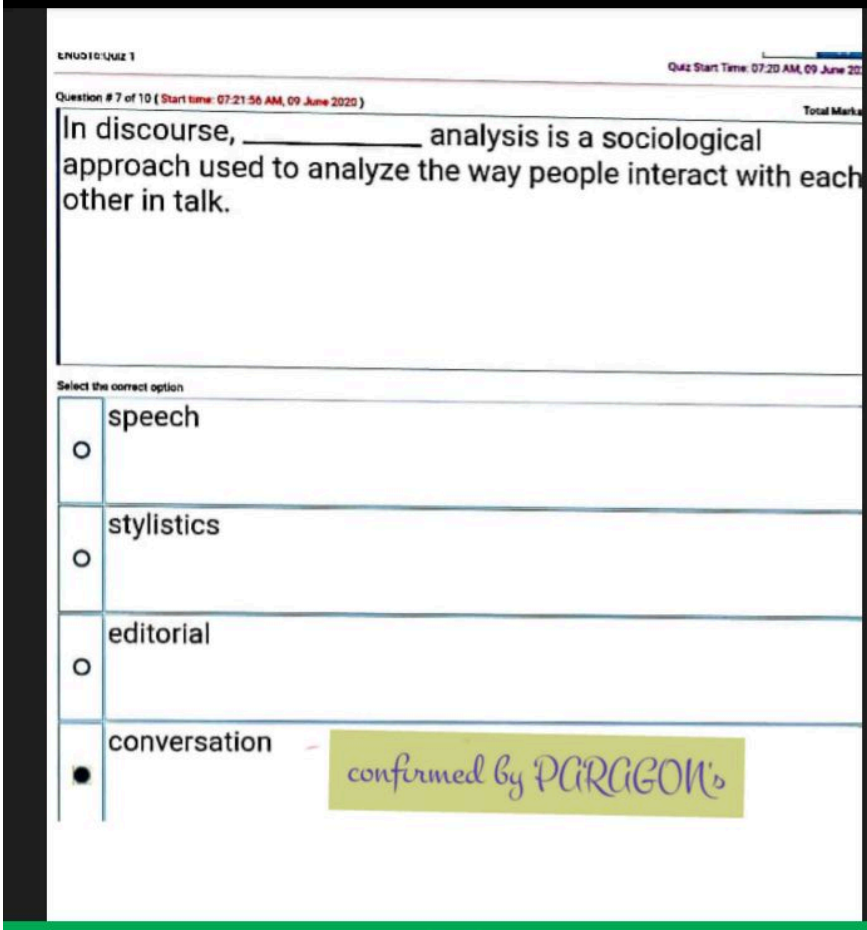


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So in any course the need is what Hutchinson says: to give what the learner lacks. One should also know what the learner knows already so that what he/she lacks can be determined. The gap between the target proficiency and existing proficiency is called the learners' "lack". A main part of a communication needs analysis is finding out how good the learners' language use is, what is their current communicative competence? Using of placement tests which have validity, face validity, authenticity, reliable, is important. Wants are learners own view of what they "want" from the course, which might be in conflict with the course and the instructor's perceptions of learners' necessities and lacks.

Topic- 029: Analyzing Learning Needs

Learning needs can be analyzed by using different tools to collect a series of snapshots which allow them to compare a target situation with the current situation, thus leading to a focused course. After gathering information through forms, questionnaires, interviews, observation tests etc. the teacher has to analyze learners' needs. The data acquired does not produce a sharply defined list of things to do, so it becomes more difficult as the course progresses. A needs analysis provides a series of snapshots which contribute to our understanding. It differentiates a General English course from ESP course and provides



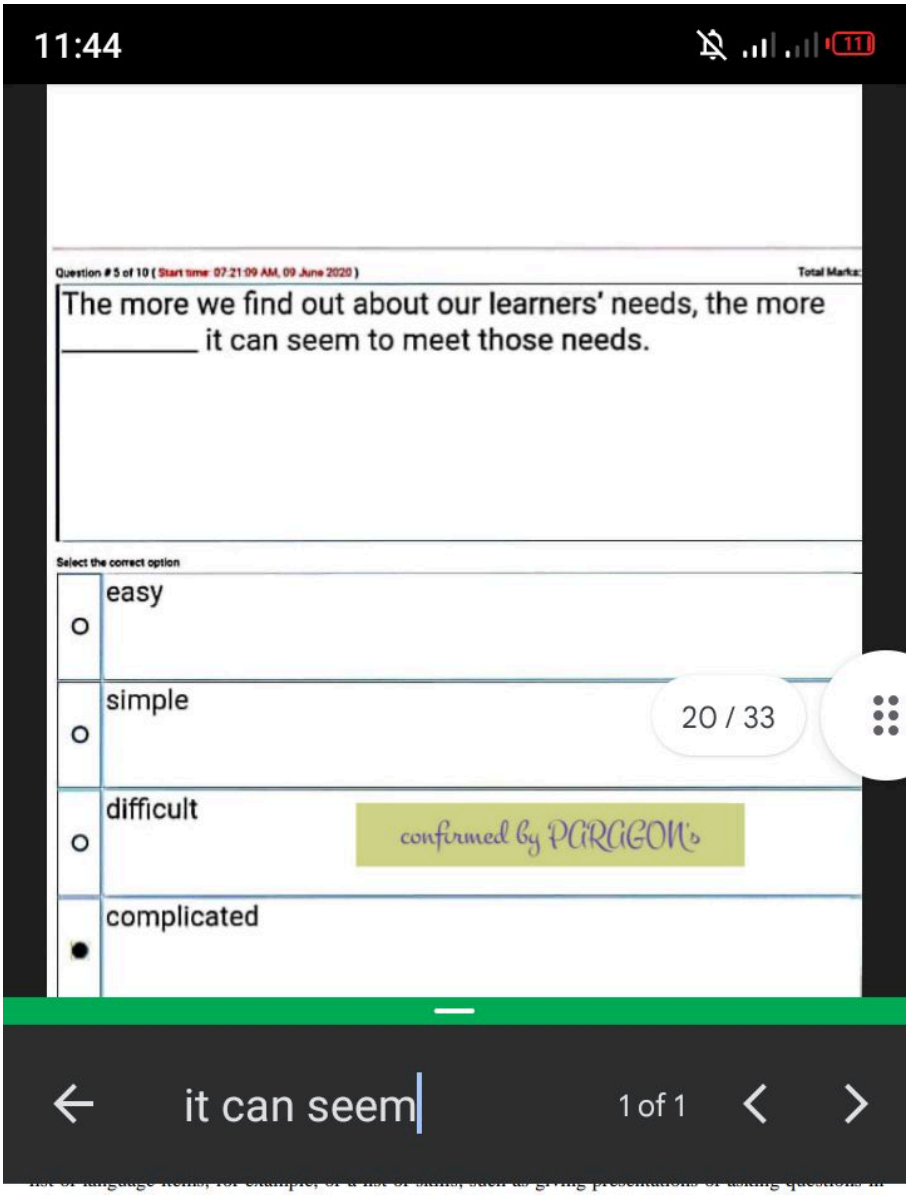
ɔciological approach 1 of 1

Linguistic competence deals with elements of language at a basic level, and tends to focus on language out of context, focusing on isolated chunks of language. Discourse competence, on the other hand, deals with language in use, although it is important to note that the word discourse can be used in a variety of ways by language professionals.

Discourse is used to describe how people interact with each other within context. This includes negotiations, correspondence, presentations, service encounters, and meetings. In this sense, business discourse refers to the spoken and written communication that is found within the world of business. The participants in the discourse have to communicate within different contexts. Different discourses require different strategies, registers, genres - spoken or written. There are many ways to analyze spoken discourse. One of these is conversation analysis, which is a sociological approach used to analyze the way people interact with each other in talk, for example, the concept of turn-taking. Conversations also have opening and closing sequences. The business communication learner needs to have an understanding of the discourse situations which he/she will face in the business world. This would involve the formal as well as the informal domain of officialdom and socializing. It is important to use appropriate written and spoken language here.

Topic- 015: Intercultural Competence

The Business Communication learner will have to be familiarized to the intercultural aspect of communication. In the globalized world of today where international education, business and tourism has been made easier through cheaper and faster means of communication, there is need for the business communicator to be culturally sensitive. Businesses are carried out with multinational companies and TNCs. At the computer interface as well, culturally sensitive language is required. Culture has to do with attitudes, behaviors, beliefs, and values. It is influenced by a multitude of factors including environment, society, gender, family, age, and ethics. It is learned, not inherited through genes. It manifests itself in interaction between people, and is continually changing. Some cultural differences are superficial, and are relatively simple to deal with. It is easy to see that people may dress or eat differently, for example cultural differences are not always so obvious. The iceberg model is often used to demonstrate how much



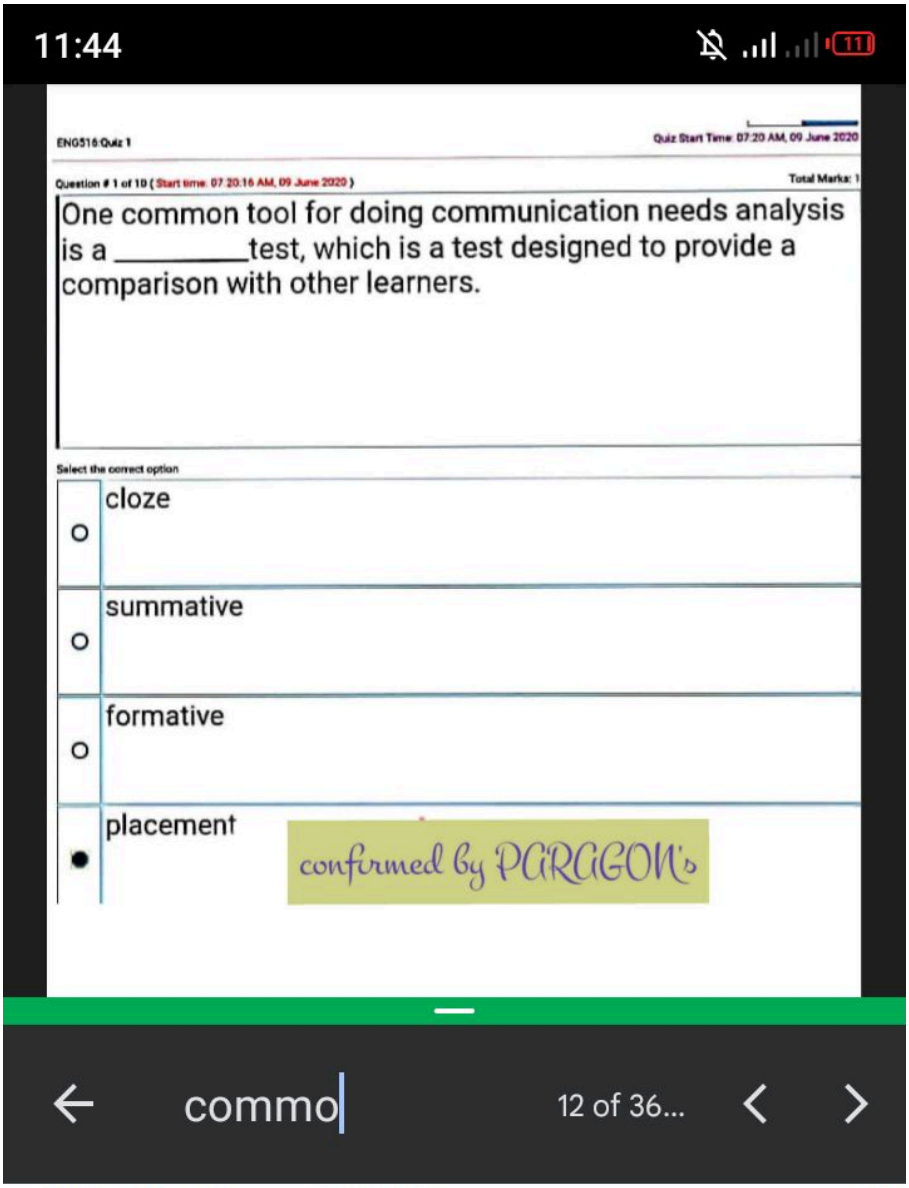
meetings, or should needs be seen in terms of the process of delivery, with the emphasis on how the learning takes place? Here we are talking about the training as seen from the individual learner's perspective:

- How does a particular learner learn?
- What affective factors need to be considered?
- What methods should I be using?

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As ever in language teaching, the answer probably draws on both perspectives. There are several possible ways of looking at needs analysis, but what is important is to appreciate what a needs analysis does. It does not produce a sharply defined list of things to do in the classroom. Indeed, the more we find out about our learners' needs, as inevitably happens as a course progresses, the more difficult it can seem to meet those needs. What a needs analysis does is offering a chance to focus on those areas which are more relevant to the learner or the company. It provides a series of snapshots, none of which gives the complete 'truth', but all of which contribute to our understanding. The more snapshots we take, the better our understanding.

The needs analysis differentiates a general English course from a course for specific purposes. On certain courses, it can also be used as a justification for what happens. A needs analysis is unique to a specific training situation. There is no standard model of needs analysis, and there is no 'single best way' to do it. A needs analysis is not an objective exercise; it entails exercising judgment and finding compromises to make the best use of resources in a particular teaching context. It is about working with



confidentiality exist. In face-to-face interaction or while observing a meeting, teachers can seek answers to previously thought out questions.

Topic - 032: Main Priorities

The other main part of a communication needs analysis is finding out the current communicative competence of learners. One common tool for this is a placement test, which is a test designed to provide a comparison with other learners (or with known standards or benchmarks) so that learners can be placed with others having similar needs and ability. Characteristics of a placement test are:

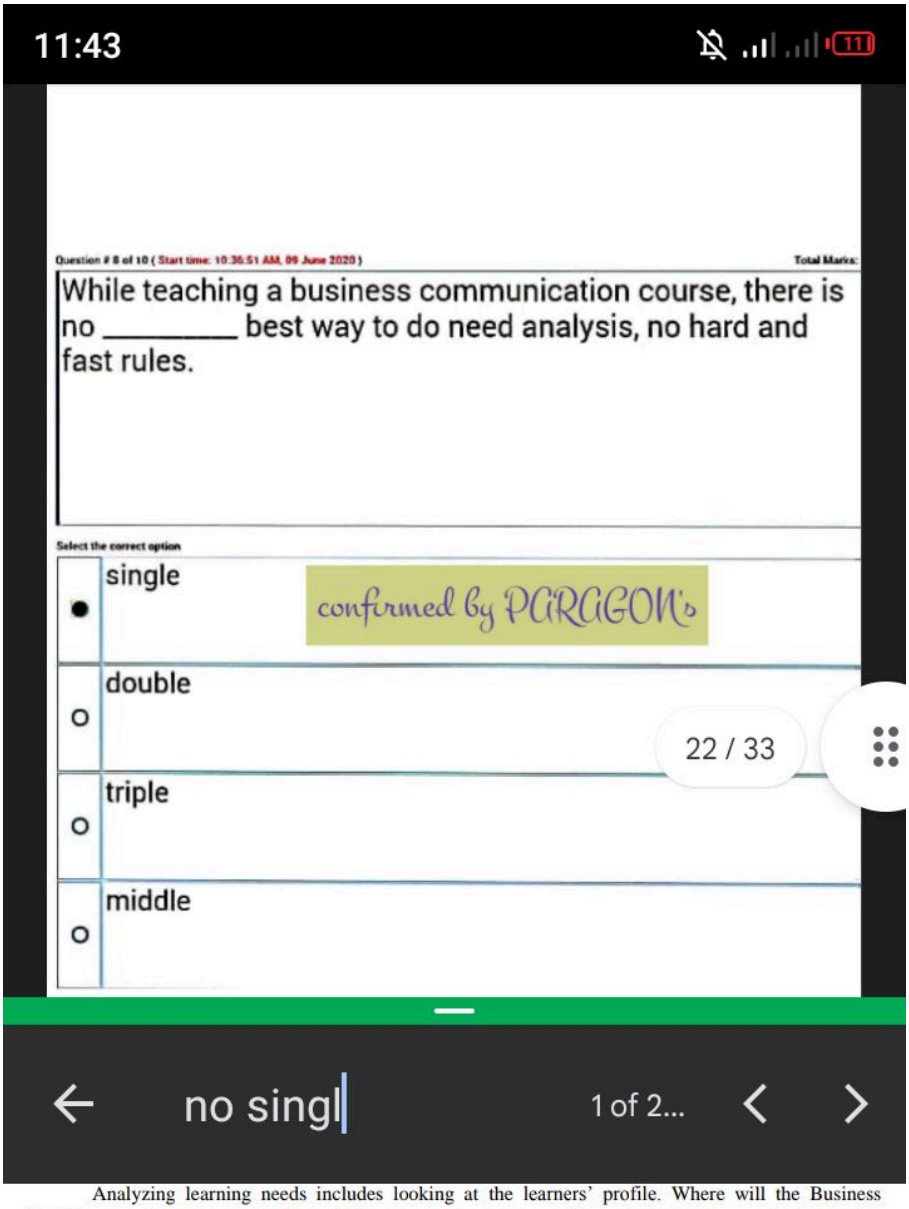
Validity: in that it should test what it is designed to test.

Face validity: Face validity is to be credible to the learner, if we give a grammar test to a learner who is interested to improve presentation skills, the prospective learner may start to question our judgment.

Authenticity: Tied with this is the question of authenticity, that the test should reflect the target language, and the way it is used (this is why a placement test should, ideally, follow the target situation analysis).

Reliability: It should be reliable so that if different testers do the same test, the result should be the same; likewise if the learner took the test two days later, they should get the same result.

Besides suiting the requirements of the learners' specific situation, other characteristics are that should be quick, and easy to administer. International tests are available for purchase and on the internet. Disadvantage is that they are tied to using particular course book or doing a particular course (they check the point at which the person can join the course). Others test with reference to guidelines and standards, such as the standards provided by the CEF (Common European Framework) or ACTFL (American



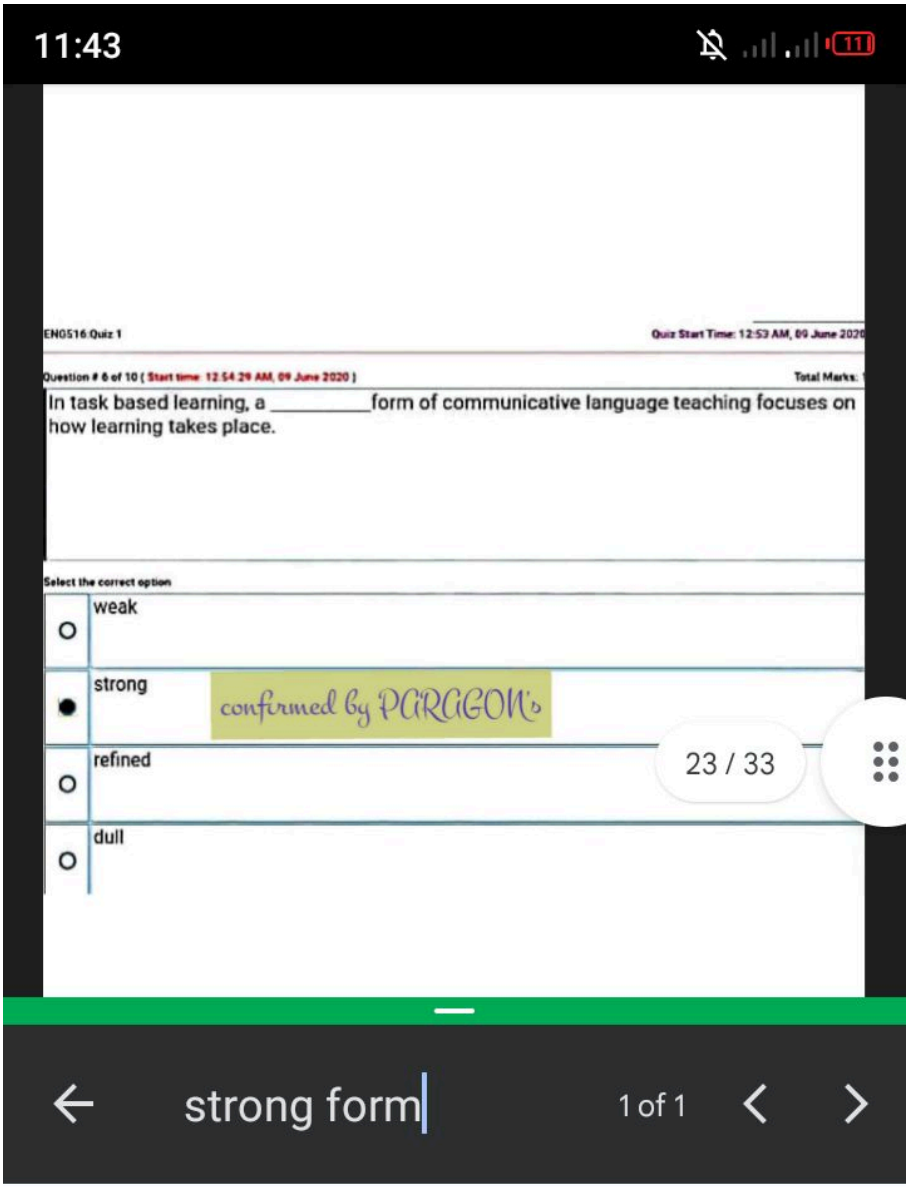
Analyzing learning needs includes looking at the learners' profile. Where will the Business English course take place and when will the course take place, are also part of analyzing needs. Analyzing learning needs includes looking into learners' purpose in taking this course. Is it to enter a job or for higher education? How do learners actually learn and what are the resources which are available to the teacher and learners to achieve success in the course?

Topic- 030: Uniqueness of Learning Situation

A needs analysis is unique to a specific training situation. There is no single best way to do it, no hard and fast rules. It entails exercising judgment and finding compromises to make the best use of resources in a particular teaching context. It is about working with learners to decide on the best way forward. At the end of all this effort, it is still inevitably vague in parts. This vagueness can be a problem with a sponsor or learner who is paying for something well defined, and is getting something that looks a little bit rough around the edges. A teacher working with companies must be aware of this, and must be able to produce a needs analysis which is businesslike and efficient, while at the same time being realistic and not making promises that cannot be met, particularly regarding what language teaching is and what it can achieve. Tied to this is the problem of using ELT jargon; part of our job as teachers is to make sure that we speak the same language as those paying for the training (sponsors). Learners and sponsors may have other views of what the teacher's 'role' is, for example, or what the word 'grammar' means. Conflict can be avoided by regular consultation, clarification, and negotiation.

Sometimes it is a problem for the teacher to satisfy the administration and company. So he/she has to make it business like and efficient, while at the same time remaining realistic and not making any promises that cannot be met, particularly what language teaching is and what it can achieve. Finding out the needs also depends on the class type. It might be an individual course, an open group (more or less homogeneous): or an open group (a public group, which draws its participants from a wide audience). Easier to find needs of the first two groups while more difficult with the third group.

Ethical questions include confidentiality, consent, and effect on careers. During a needs analysis teachers gain access to some often quite private or sensitive information, which might need to be handled

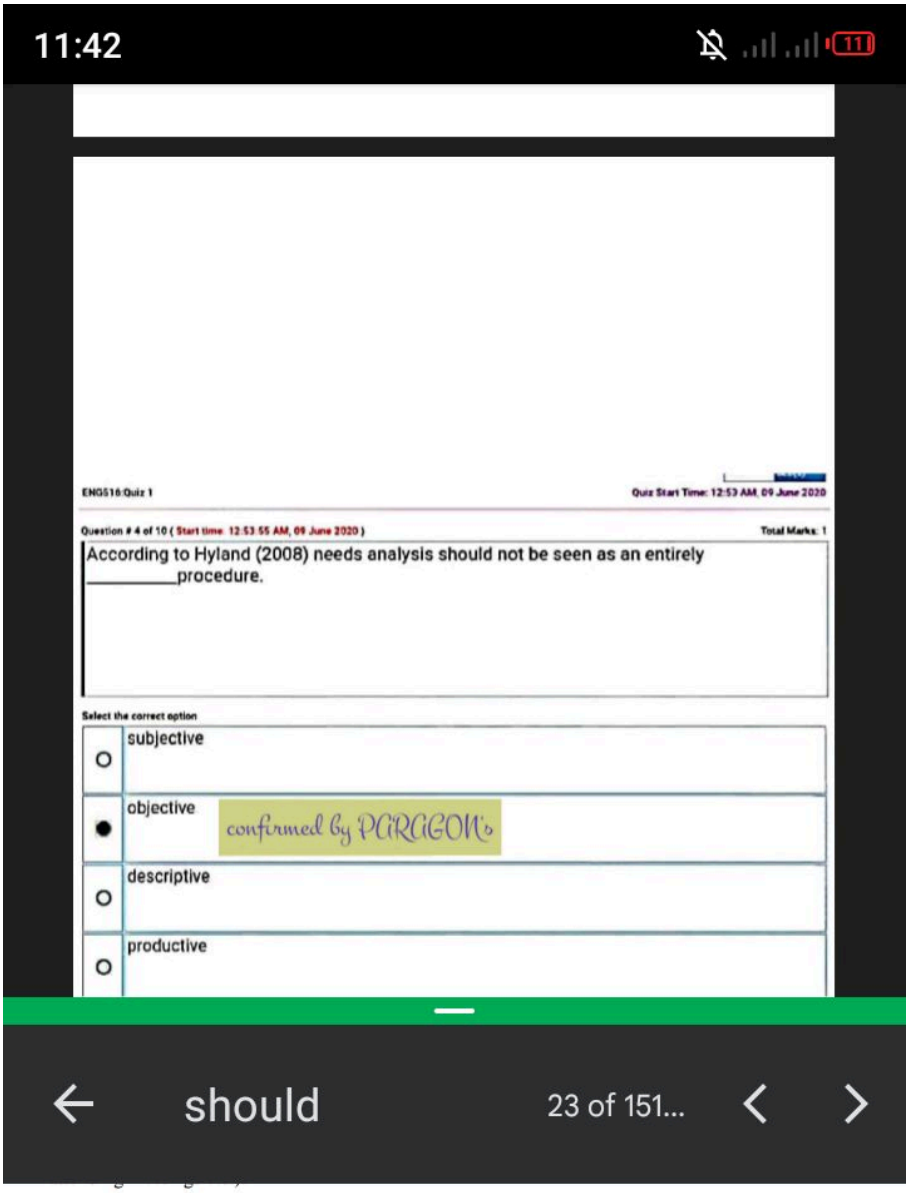


The task-based approach aims at providing opportunities for learners to experiment with and explore both spoken and written language through learning activities which are designed to engage learners in the authentic, practical and functional use of language for meaningful purposes. Learners are encouraged to activate and use whatever language they already have in the process of completing a task. The use of tasks will also give a clear and purposeful context for the teaching and learning of grammar and other language features as well as skills. Task-based learning stimulates a natural desire in learners to improve their language competence by challenging them to complete meaningful tasks.

A strong form of communicative language teaching focuses on how learning takes place; in other words, it argues that language is learned via the negotiation of meaning in real communication. People learn by using the language to achieve a specific outcome. The theory is that people do not learn in a neat, pre-ordained fashion, so deciding what language items to focus on is not an effective way to teach. It may be much better to provide the right input and atmosphere, which allow learning to take place at the individual's own pace and in response to their needs.

In the Business English classroom, this is often done via tasks, which are activities where the focus is primarily on using language to do something. It is the outcome of the task which is important, just as in the business world; the language is a means to an end not an end in itself. Traditional language exercises focus on learning language rules. The theory is that language is learned via the interaction; the learners learn by doing the task. Many researchers claim that task-based learning, coupled with judicious feedback allows learners to pay some attention to form is the most productive way of learning a language.

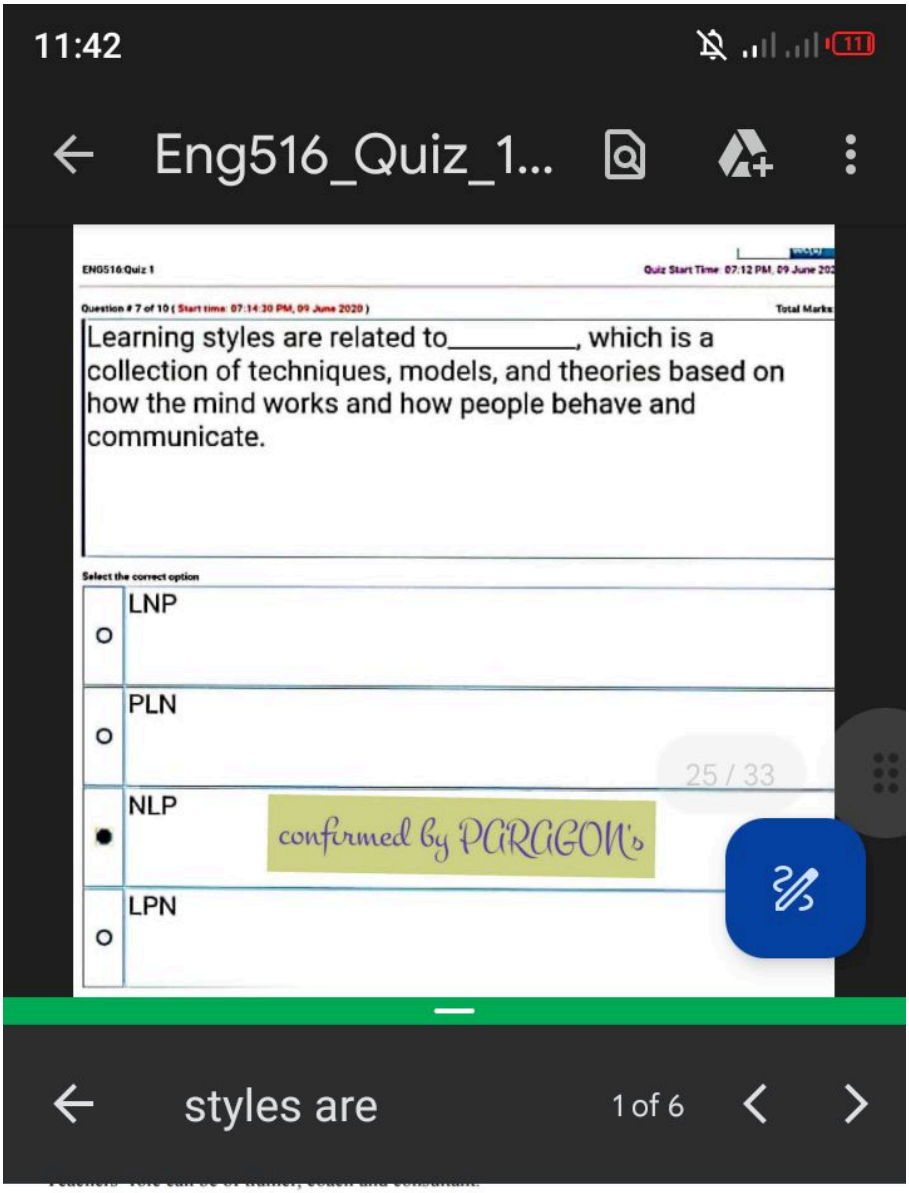
The great advantage for the Business English learners is that the language produced while doing a task can be immediately relevant. The disadvantage is that it is often difficult to predict exactly what will happen during a task, which can make them difficult to plan or assess. For the less experienced teacher, there may also be a feeling of loss of control. In addition, some tasks can be completed with a minimum of language input from the participants, which makes them not necessarily the best way to provide maximum exposure to a useful language.



When the decision maker about the course design is the sponsor as well, he/she is very clear about needs of learners. For example, a copy of a report is submitted by a freelance teacher for a language school to a company. In this case, the sponsors already have firm ideas about what they want the course to look like. Unlike the previous two examples, this somewhat formal report has been written so that someone else can take over the running of the course. Some of the key course design decisions already appear to have been made, which partly reflect the priorities and conditions laid down by the sponsor, Mr Lambada. This report illustrates once again the difficulty of making a clear divide between information gathering, and course design: in practice, the two are often inextricably linked.

Needs analysis should not be seen as an entirely objective procedure, as Hyland reminds us, 'Needs analysis is like any other classroom practice in that it involves decisions based on teachers' interests, values, and beliefs about teaching, learning and language.' Sothe needs analysis is preparatory and ongoing. It is the foundation of any business English course. It considers different tools that teachers can use to collect a series of snapshots, which allow them to compare a target situation with a current situation, thus leading to a focused course.

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A means analysis is a description of the training environment: what is available in terms of equipment, materials, facilities, and time. Means analysis normally produces lists which have an important bearing on the cost of the course and distribution of responsibilities. It entails looking at matters of coordination, availability, timings and preparation. Means analysis involves reflecting on key issues and personal/professional targets along the cline and methods for achieving them. Needs analysis is about making ongoing evaluations.

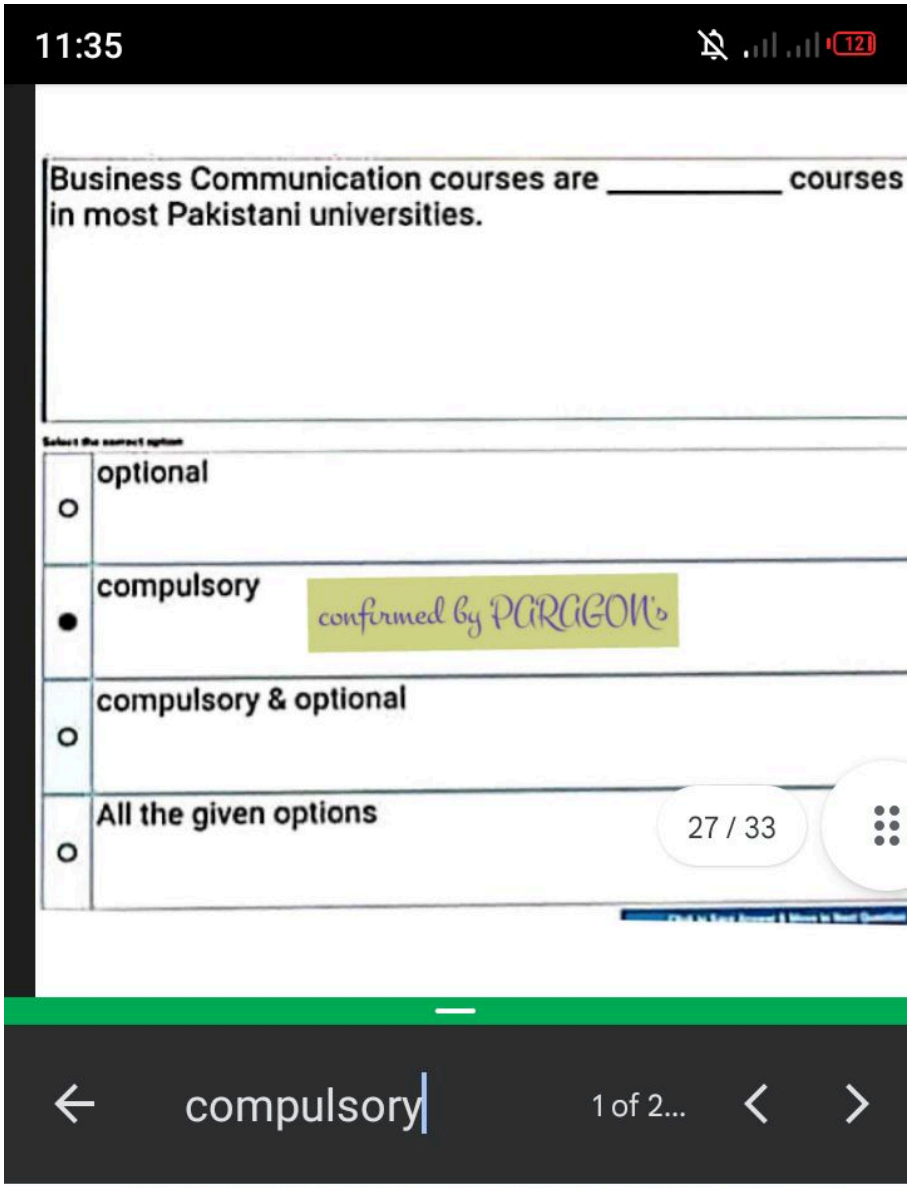
Topic- 034: Language Styles

Learning success depends on a number of factors. There are a number of different ways to look at learning styles. One is based on the findings of research into brain function, that the right and left sides of the brain play different roles in how we process information. Depending on which side of their brain is dominant, there are the 'left-brain' learners who tend to analyze, and to be logical and objective. They may prefer traditional lectures, reading, and clearly structured classroom activities and 'Right-brain' learners tend to be more impulsive and informal, and may appreciate the use of graphics and role-play activities to enhance their learning.

Learning styles are related to NLP (Neuro-Linguistic Programming), which is a collection of techniques, models, and theories based on how the mind works and how people behave and communicate. NLP has been useful to some business English teachers because of the insight it gives into various communication skills such as building rapport, non-verbal communication, active listening, and so on, but it can also help our learners understand how they perceive the world, and what affects that perception.

Howard Gardner's multiple intelligence theory provides another way to compare learners' learning needs, suggesting eight different types of intelligence: Bodily-Kina-esthetic, Intrapersonal, Interpersonal, Verbal-Linguistic, Logical-Mathematical, Musical, Visual-Spatial, and Naturalist.

Teachers can look at their learners in terms of these intelligences, and draw conclusions as to what learning styles and strategies might be most suitable. Of course, trainers will develop their

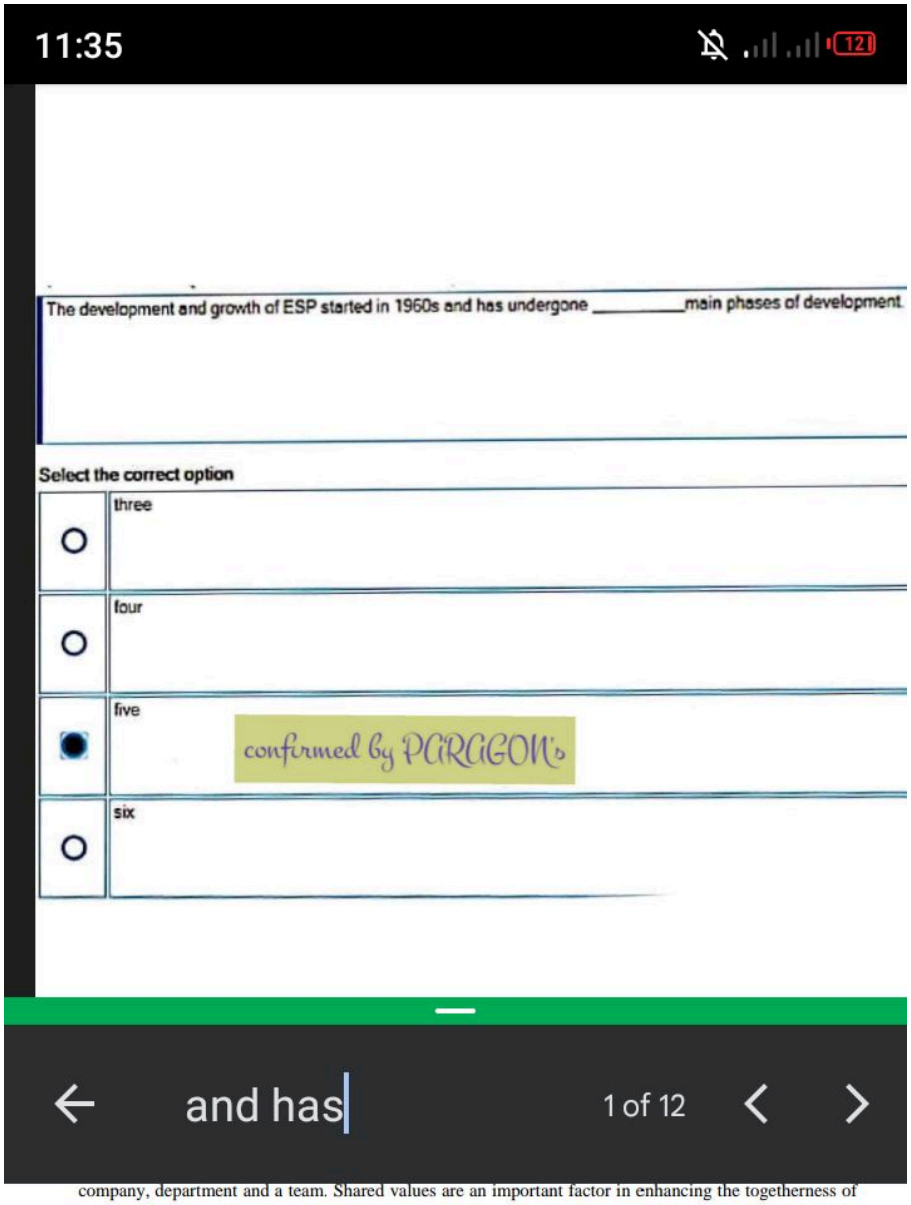


English Communication is about language use, the issue of communicative competence is important. Perhaps the most influential models have been based on work done by Hymes in the 1960s, Canale and Swain in the 70s, and Bachman and Palmer in the 80s. The basic argument, which arose out of dissatisfaction with earlier teaching approaches, is that there are various components which need to be considered when discussing language skills, of which knowing about language is only one. Language learners also need to be able to use the language in real-life situations. Various ways of dividing communicative competence into its component parts have been discussed over the years, with teachers being particularly interested in the teachability of such components. Business English teachers need to focus on three key components in particular: linguistic competence, discourse competence, and intercultural competence.

Topic- 12: Rationale of the Course

Business Communication courses are compulsory courses in most of the Pakistani universities. They are taught to students of engineering, IT, management, mathematics, science, accounts and finance, and medicine. Mostly, it is taught as General English in the first semester and then for two semesters under various names as Report Writing, BC Workshop and Business Communication focusing on the four language skills and some technical aspects of business writing. The emphasis in most of the cases is on the theoretical aspects and not on actual language use in real life situations. They are graded courses and affect students CGPA. However, teachers use a course book, usually a readymade material to teach them which is not relevant to local contexts. Classes are large with students from various disciplines and various academic backgrounds and abilities. Motivation is low as students do not see how and where they would use the content. This course aims to teach/train teacher how to teach Business Communication. Books that are usually used are Gerson and Gerson, Guffy and Babcock, and others authored and complied by Indian writers. They are not effective because the needs of the students are not met. Also sometimes students focus more on their core courses and consider the business communication course as not really relevant to their overall aims.

These undergraduates are young degree students who have no background knowledge or experience in the business world. The students view it as just another module in their Social Sciences which they just have to pass in order to get it out of the way of their core subjects, which are more important for them. Usually students cannot communicate in spoken as well as written English. As B.C.



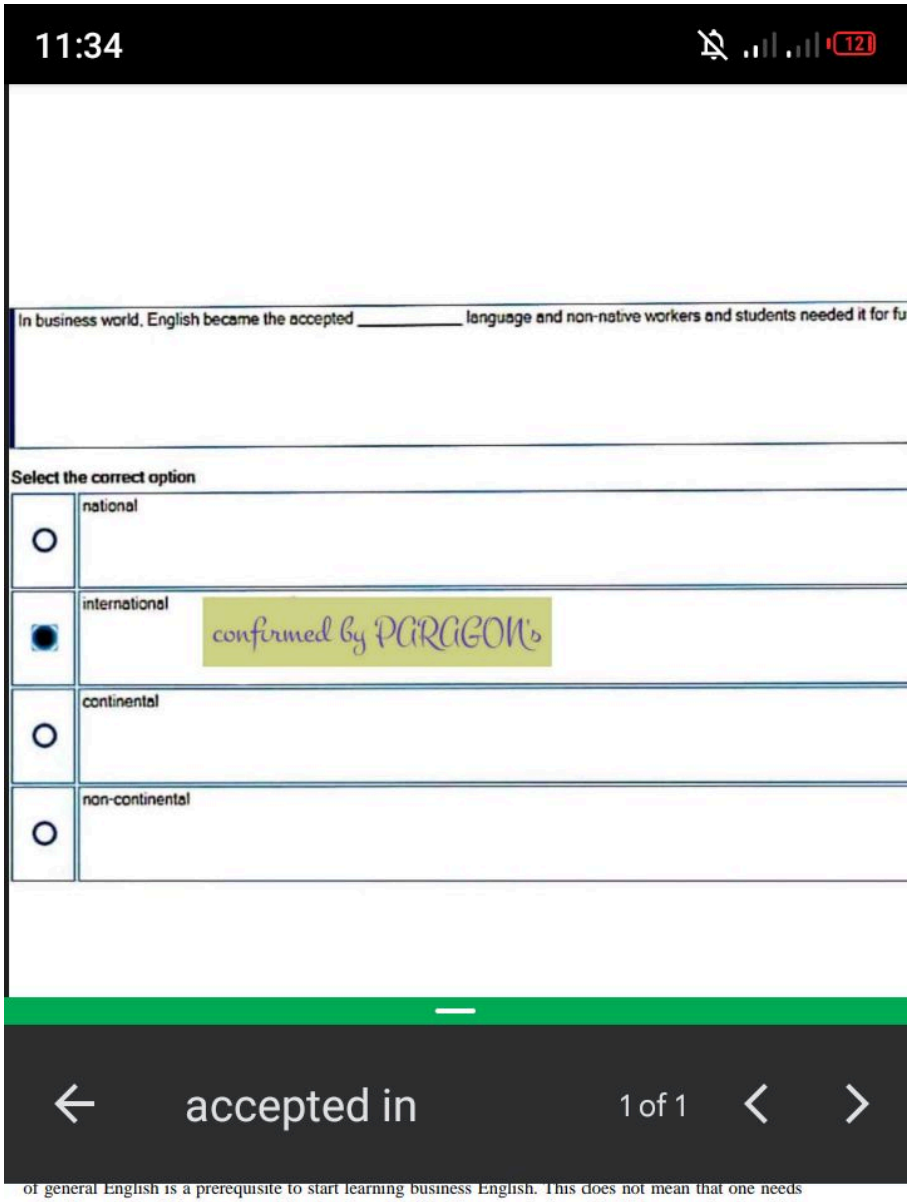
company, department and a team. Shared values are an important factor in enhancing the togetherness of the members, thereby improving their performance. Effective communication is at the heart of creating cultural understanding within a company.

The legitimate scope of business English teachers is to design and deliver courses which aim to increase the language knowledge and communication skills, management skills, cultural awareness and professional context.

Topic- 004: Development of Business Communication

Communication has been influenced by a variety of disciplines – linguistics, general language, e - learning and teaching and management training. One area that has been important in the development of ESP is EST (English for Science and Technology). The development and growth of ESP started in 1960s and has undergone five main phases of development:

Phase 1: The Concept of Special Language: Register Analysis. In 1960s and early 1970s, the basic principle was that each field has its own particular register. Specific registers were to be analyzed to identify their grammatical and lexical features to be used in teaching materials. The aim was to make the syllabus as relevant as possible to learners' needs, giving high priority to language forms that students were likely to meet in Science studies. However, there was very little that was distinctive in the sentence grammar of Science English, except a tendency to favor certain grammatical forms, like the simple present tense, passive voice and nominal compounds. This meant that there was nothing which was not present in General English (Ewer and Latorre 1969).



of general English is a prerequisite to start learning business English. This does not mean that one needs to be fluent in English to start studying business English. There are business English course books which are designed for different levels of knowledge of English learners. Business communication courses do focus on language skills; however, this focus may take place in specific teaching situations. Besides this, there is also a specific corpus, a particular context and a specific communication. Therefore, its methodology also differentiates it from general English.

Topic - 002: Origin of Business Communication

The teaching of business communication is not a coherent movement but grew out of the converging of a number of trends, which are as follows:

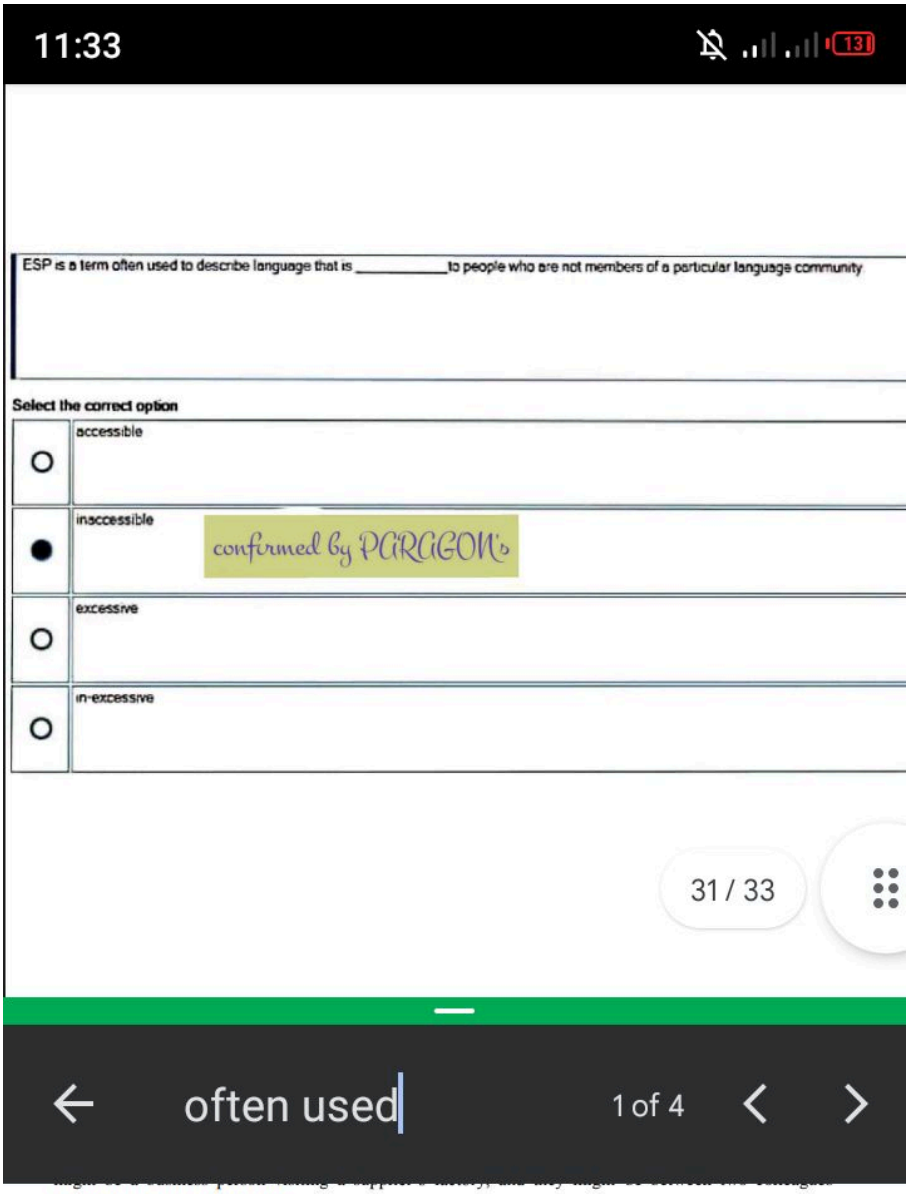
a. The post WW-II world has been dominated by two trends – the importance of commerce and technology, which generated the demand for a unifying language and because of various factors, one being the power of the USA, this role fell to English. As English became the accepted international language, non-native workers and students needed it for functional and academic purposes.

b. Oil crisis of 1970s resulted in a massive flow of funds and Western expertise into the oil-rich countries. English language became a big business and commercial pressures began to exert their influence, and demand on the English teaching profession for cost effective courses.

2. Revolution in Linguistics: At the same time, the traditional method of teaching formal aspect of language was replaced by tailored courses which covered how language was used in actual communication. Traditionally, the aim of linguistics was to describe the rules of English. However, new studies shifted attention away from formal aspects of language to how language is used in an actual life. This led to the awareness of the following:

- The differences in written and spoken language.
- The difference between the language of commerce and the language of engineering.
- The language needs of different groups are different.
- Also that if language varies from one situation of use to another, it should be possible to determine the features of specific situations and then make these the basis of learner's courses.

3. Developments in educational psychology also influenced the rise of ESP, by focusing on the learner



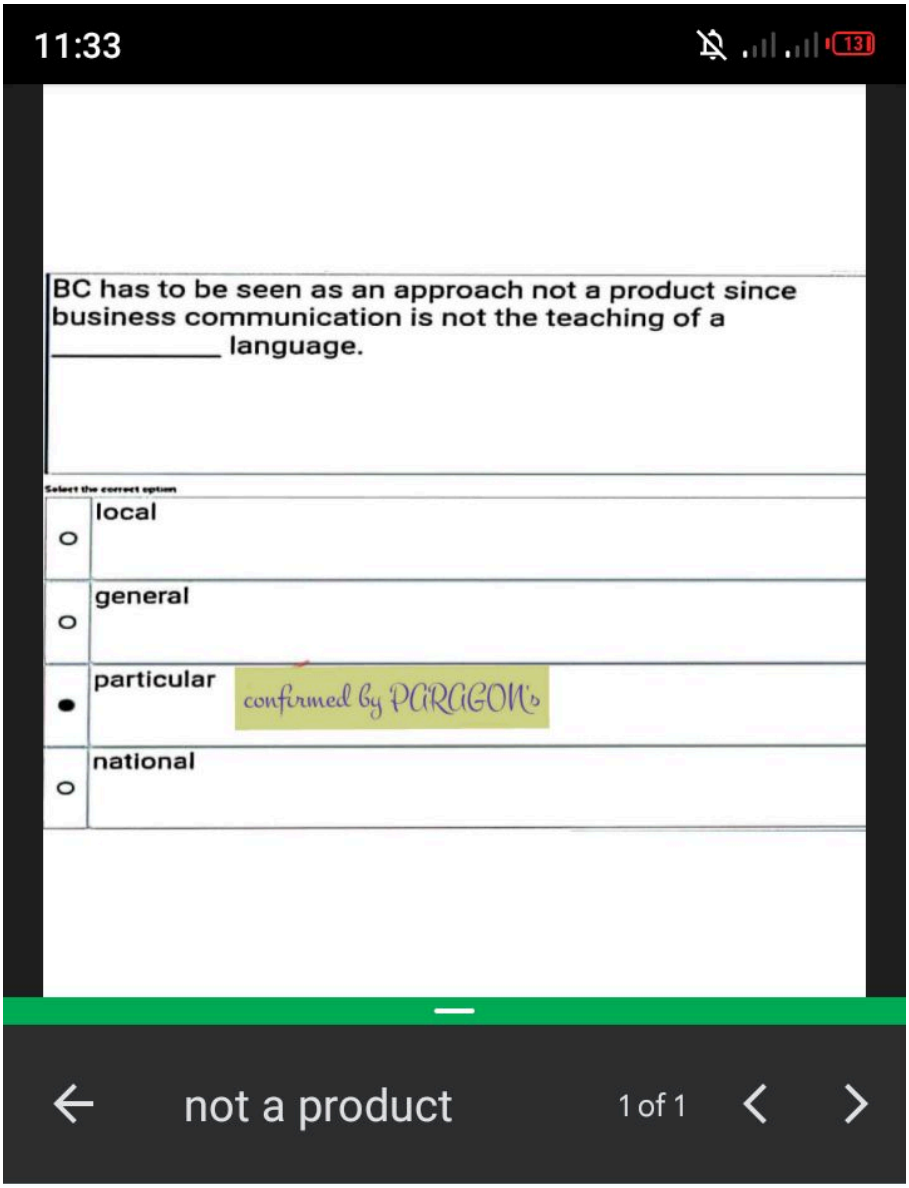
discussing an important deadline.

But some groups of people use language in other ways too, ways that are not as familiar to outsiders. They use specialist words to make communication, within the group, easier and more efficient. Every profession does this (indeed, one defining feature of a profession is that it has its own linguistic identity). People use specific language to communicate in specific contexts. Business communities are not different. Accountants use the language of accounting (specific lexis) to talk about accounting matters (specific context). Sales engineers use specific language to discuss their product specifications with their customers. These are both business communities, but they probably wouldn't understand each other's specialist vocabulary. English for Specific Purposes (ESP) is a term often used to describe language that is inaccessible to people who are not members of a particular language community.

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Business English is an umbrella term for a mixture of general everyday English, general Business English, and ESP. It is not limited to words or phrases that only appear in some special business world. For example, a quick glance at the language of advertising soon shows a wonderful variety of metaphorical language, such as, *health drink with more muscle*.

Yet there are some other things which make business English distinctive. Firstly, business people do a variety of things with language; they socialize, predict, analyze, negotiate, buy, write, persuade, compromise, telephone, compete, market, sell, produce, interview, train, travel, plan, investigate, deal, advertise, explain - the list is endless. These are done in a specific business context, and for business

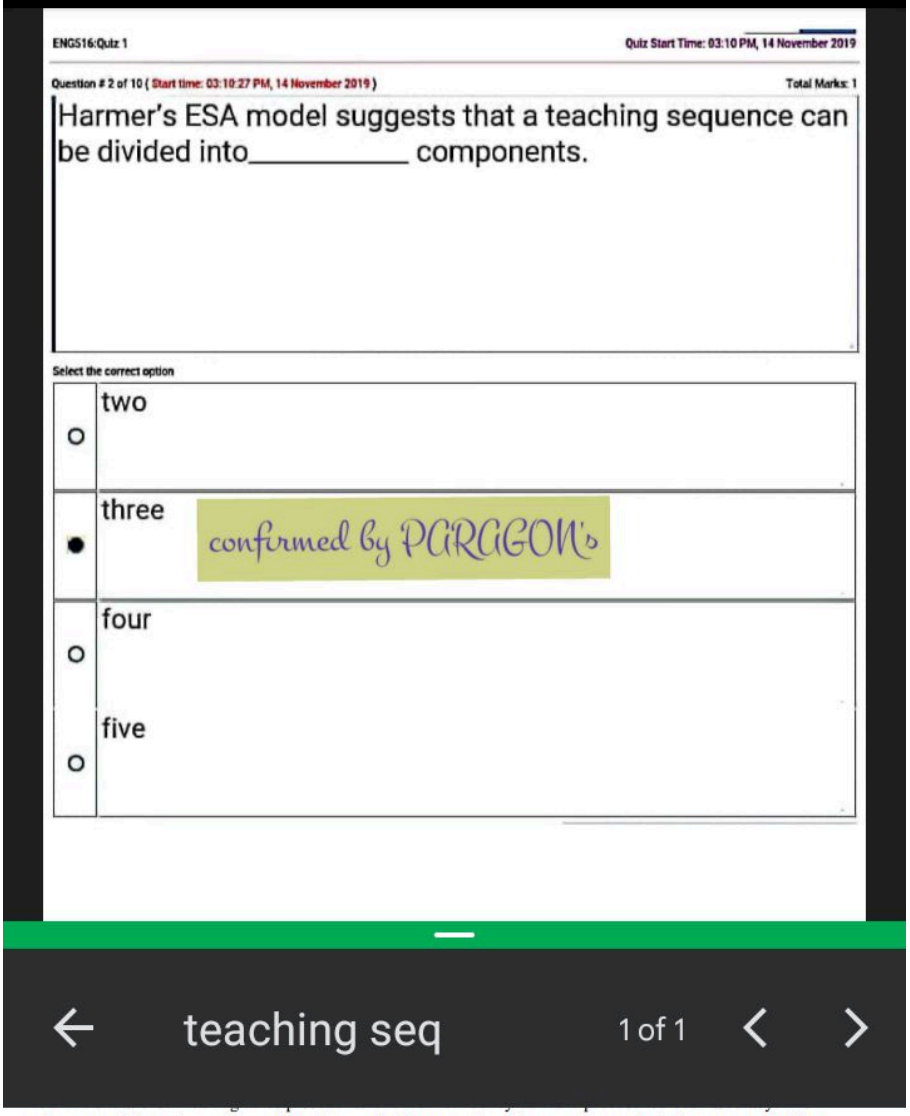


methodologies for the business communication class. The methodologies used are those which can easily be applied in any other language class.

Business Communication has to be seen as an approach not a product since business communication is not the teaching of a particular language nor does it consist of a particular type of methodology or material. It should be taken as an approach to language learning which is based on the learner's need.

As for learners' needs are concerned, the question to be asked by Business Communication teachers, as all ESP teachers is: Why does this learner need to learn a foreign language? Once the initial need is identified, other questions will follow from it, some of which will relate to the learners themselves, some to the context of learning and others to the nature of the language in which the learner will need to operate. But the whole analysis derives from the initial identified need on the part of the learner to learn a language.

Business communication teaching, like all ESP teaching, then is an approach to language teaching in which all decisions as to content and method are based on the learner's reason for learning. Dudley Evans and John's (2000), definition for English for specific Purposes, can be applied to Business Communication teaching as well. They say that it is related to specific disciplines, and is designed to meet specific needs of the learner. The tree of ELT has shown that all language teaching is primarily concerned with communication and learning. So, Business Communication should be seen not as a particular language product but as an approach to language teaching which is directed by specific and apparent reasons for learning.



often argued that there are two basic forms of CLT, a weak and a strong one; both forms are used in business English classrooms. The weak form of CLT focuses on what is to be learned. A typical approach here is PPP, where language is presented, practiced using a variety of different activities, and finally produced through some sort of communicative activity. A variation on this is the deep-end approach, where learners are asked to perform a task that makes demands on their competence in using language, and then their performance is diagnosed, leading to a focus on the specific language items. Another alternative suggested by Michael Lewis is to create a learning cycle which starts with observation, followed by hypothesis and experiment (OHE). Harmer's ESA model suggests that a teaching sequence can be divided into three components where the learners engage emotionally with the situation, study the language, and then activate it. All these approaches focus on what is to be learned.

Topic- 018: Task based Learning

The task-based approach aims at providing opportunities for learners to experiment with and explore both spoken and written language through learning activities which are designed to engage learners in the authentic, practical and functional use of language for meaningful purposes. Learners are encouraged to activate and use whatever language they already have in the process of completing a task. The use of tasks will also give a clear and purposeful context for the teaching and learning of grammar and other language features as well as skills. Task-based learning stimulates a natural desire in learners to improve their language competence by challenging them to complete meaningful tasks.

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